

The New and Revised ...

CHARTING THE COURSE



The Grand Encampment of Knights Templar of the U.S.A.

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A TEMPLAR COMPENDIUM

"Charting the Course" is a continuing account of the structure and purposes of the Grand Encampment of Knights Templar. Through consistent revisions, since it was first prepared and distributed during the term of the late Grand Master and former Secretary of the Army, Hon. Wilber M. Brucker, it serves to offer to both recruits and seasoned Templars a concise description of Templary's structure and purposes - its committees, its aspirations, its exemplification of Christian Masonry.

As my recent predecessors in office have done during their terms, I have authorized the printing of today's updated version. It merely updates; it does not alter the form or the basic content which was originally issued during the 1964-67 triennium by Grand Master Brucker and his officers.

It is my hope that every Templar and prospective Templar will study the new "Charting the Course" for a better understanding of the past and present of our Templar Order.



A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Donald H. Smith".

Donald H. Smith, Grand Master

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Charles R. Neumann".

Grand Recorder

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THE KNIGHTS OF THE TEMPLE PRE-MASONIC TEMPLARS

There is no universal agreement on the details of the story of the Knights of the Temple. Dates and spellings of names vary from author to author among Masonic and non-Masonic historians alike. The following account is the general picture which emerges from a variety of sources on the period.

In 1118 Hugh de Payens of Champagne persuaded King Baldwin II of Jerusalem to allow him and eight others to install themselves in the former mosque Al-Aqsa in the Temple area. The group had three classes: knights, all of noble birth; sergeants, members of the bourgeoisie who were grooms and stewards; clerics. Their badge was a red cross on a white tunic for the knights and a black tunic for the sergeants.

They called themselves Knights of the Temple and their main duty was to keep the road from Jerusalem to the coast free of bandits. They also provided the kingdom with a regular army of trained soldiers whose permanent residence was assured.

In 1128 Baldwin II sent de Payens to Europe to recruit soldiers for Damascus, torn by riots among the city's powerful. The army of Templars grew.

In the summer of 1147, the kings of Europe gathered in Constantinople for a Crusade. Grand Master Everard of Barre joined their army with a regiment of recruits. He would later serve as an envoy to the Byzantine authorities for King Louis of France.

The army struggled across Asia Minor, cold and hungry. The royalty was not used to discipline. In January 1148 the party almost lost their lives when the vanguard disobeyed orders at Cadmos Mountain. The next day King Louis turned command of the column over to Grand Master Everard.

The Templars remained laymen although they took the triple monastic vows of poverty, chastity, and obedience. They obeyed only their Grand Master - whose sole earthly superior was the Pope.

The trained, fit warriors of military age remained in the Holy Land. The veterans, past fighting, were sent home to manage the ever-growing estates of the Templars in Europe.

A great many of the Templars spoke fluent Arabic. They were financial agents for visiting Crusaders and their banking activities eased relationships with Muslim merchants. Saladin visited them during the negotiations in 1167.

By 1150 more than half the knights in the army of Jerusalem came from the Knights Templar and the Knights Hospitaller. There was much hostility between the Hospitallers and Templars. According to historian Alfred Duggan, "Knights of the Hospital, without thinking opposed any policy favoured by their rivals of the Temple."

Templars gave alms but not to the extent of the Hospitallers. Theirs was a more military order, famed for their courage in attack. By 1187 the two orders were the chief landowners in Outremer. Recruits came in steadily from the west and many Palestinian nobles joined.

The Templars cost the King of Jerusalem nothing for they supported themselves and their castles. However, he also had no control over them, and they frequently defied the King.

It was not uncommon for Templars to refuse to allow their tenants to pay levies to the Church, refuse to cooperate in certain ventures, give irresponsible advice to the Court, and refuse to fight beside the Hospitallers as a general rule. However, their abilities as soldiers were so great their lack of cooperation was generally overlooked.

In 1152 Raymond II was murdered by a band of assassins as he returned to Tripoli. As there was no adult male heir Tortosa was handed over to the Templars to hold.

On January 25, 1153, King Baldwin III and his army, including Grand Master Bernard de Tremelay and the Templars, appeared before the walls of Ascalon to take the city. In late July, 40 Templars penetrated the city through a breach finally made in the wall. They were killed by the defenders and their bodies hung out over the city walls. The attack began anew and on August 19 the city surrendered. The Grand Master was killed in battle.

In the spring of 1153, the widowed Princess of Antioch married Reynald of Chatillon, the younger son of a French count who had come to Palestine with King Louis on the Second Crusade and stayed on. Reynald joined Emperor Manuel and drove the Armenians back into Cilicia. He presented the reconquered country to the Templars who reconstructed the castles of Gastun and Baghras on the Syrian Gates.

Emperor Manuel made a truce with Nur el-Din in 1159. Part of the agreement was the return of some Christian prisoners including Grand Master Bertrand of Blancfort who had been captured at Tiberias.

King Almalric, in 1173, made peace with the Assassins and they joined in an alliance against Nur el-Din. In return, the Assassins asked for an end to the tribute imposed by the Templars on various Assassin villages.

As the Assassin envoys journeyed past Tripoli, Templar Walter of Mesnil, with the consent of Grand Master Odo of Saint-Amand, ambushed and slew the Assassin Ambassadors. King Almalric was horrified and ordered the Grand Master to hand over Walter. The Grand Master refused, stating he recognized no authority but the Pope. Almalric sent troops to the Grand Master at Sidon, forced his way in, kidnapped Walter, and cast him into prison at Tyre. He then made futile plans to demand the Pope dissolve the Order of Knights of the Temple.

In 1174 Raymond of Tripoli was Regent of the kingdom. He was supported by the Hospitallers and opposed by the Templars. Raymond made an enemy of Gerard of Ridefort, a prominent Templar and later Grand Master.

Saladin crossed the frontier from Egypt on November 18, 1177. The Templars defended Gaza but Saladin marched straight to Ascalon instead where he managed to contain the king before marching on Jerusalem. The Templars abandoned Gaza and marched to rescue King Baldwin IV. Then they moved on and attacked Saladin's army near Montgisard on November 25. The Templar army was victorious.

The Templars insisted Baldwin build a castle fortress on the upper Jordan between Lake Huleh and the Sea of Galilee to command the ford where Jacob wrestled with the angel, known as the Ford of Sorrows. This was in direct violation of the treaty then in effect.

Saladin offered to pay Baldwin to stop the building, but the king refused. In the spring of 1179, Saladin moved into action to stop the building. He first attacked Baldwin. Templar Humphrey

of Toran held up the Muslims while the king escaped and was mortally wounded in the battle. Saladin marched on against the new castle.

On June 10 Saladin defeated the Christian army and took prisoners including Grand Master Odo of Saint-Amand. All of the important prisoners were ransomed except the Grand Master. The Muslims proposed to exchange the Grand Master for an important Muslim prisoner, but the Grand Master was too proud to admit any Muslim could be of equal value to him and remained in a dungeon at Damascus until his death.

In 1185 King Baldwin IV announced his will which provided for him to be succeeded by his five-year-old nephew. Grand Master Arnold of Torroge, who succeeded Odo of Saint-Amand, had just died and Gerard of Ridefort was the new Grand Master. Gerard and the barons agreed on the boy king and he was crowned.

King Baldwin V died in August 1186 at the age of six. The body was dispatched to Jerusalem under Templar escort. The kingdom was again divided. Sibylla, widow of one king and mother of another, claimed the throne. The Templars had sworn they would not support her at the time of the death of Baldwin IV. The other contender was Raymond of Tripoli, archenemy of Grand Master Gerard.

The Templars closed the gates of Jerusalem and posted guards. With great haste, they crowned Sibylla with Guy of Lusignan as her regent.

At the Springs of Cresson, near the Templar Castle of La Feve, on May 31, 1187, one hundred Templars and 40 lay knights charged against 7,000 mamlukes of Saladin. Only three Templars, including the Grand Master, survived, all badly wounded.

The remaining Templars joined the army which set out to avenge the Springs of Cresson, using the money sent by Henry II of England in expiation of the murder of Thomas a Becket. They were supposed to be holding the money for a Crusade which Henry had sworn to undertake.

The army was led by King Guy. It also included the Hospitallers whose Grand Master had been killed at the Springs of Cresson. On July 3, 1187, the Templars called a halt by the hamlet of Hattin for the night. Count Raymond protested that it was only three miles of downhill road to the Lake of Galilee where it was much safer, but King Guy was inclined to take the advice of the Templars.

At sunrise on July 4, Saladin led the disastrous attack. The True Cross fell into the hands of the Muslims. King Guy and Grand Master Gerard were taken prisoner. The Grand Master was held for ransom. The rest of the knights were hacked to pieces on the spot.

Saladin took the Grand Master to Gaza and offered his freedom for the city. The Templars immediately surrendered it. In 1189 Saladin met the Crusaders at Acre. The Grand Master was killed in the battle on October 4, 1189. It was the beginning of the end.

A peace was made with Saladin in February 1229 and the Templars lost their headquarters in the Temple. Peter (or Thomas) of Montagu was Grand Master. In 1243 the Temple was returned and the Templars, under Grand Master Herman of Perigord, decided they could get back Outre Jordan as well.

The entire army of Outremer mustered at Acre, the largest Christian host ever assembled in the Holy Land. On October 17, 1244, at La Forbie, a few miles north of Gaza, the battle was joined. Of more than 300 Templars only 33 survived. The Grand Master was killed. The total dead numbered

over 5,000. The Crusaders retreated, leaving only a few men to hold the castles and walled towns. By 1247 the Muslims held all but the coastal towns.

In 1250 St. Louis, King of France, led a Crusade to Outremer. On Shrove Tuesday, February 8, 1250, the army attacked the infidels at their camps near Mansourah. Caught by surprise, the infidels fled into town where they rallied and proceeded to kill nearly all the Christian vanguard which charged after them, including 300 Templars.

St. Louis and his remaining division battled to the town and by nightfall held the infidel camp and the bridgehead outside of town. By April the tide had again turned. The Sultan had killed most of the Christian army, including Grand Master William of Sonnac, and St. Louis surrendered.

In April 1268 the Bibars took Beaufort, a Templar castle. They freed the women and children; and enslaved rather than killed the men. The Templar numbers were rapidly dwindling.

In 1290 the Templars held only Acre, Tyre, and the castle at Sidon. In March 1291, the Sultan Al-Ashraf marched on Acre. The siege began on April 6. The infidels broke through the inner wall on May 15 and on the 18th entered the city. The Grand Master was killed. The next day infidels took Tyre. At Sidon, the Templars held out until July.

The remaining defenders fled to Cyprus. It was the end of the Order of Knights of the Temple of Jerusalem in the Holy Land. Not quite 22 years later Grand Master Jacques de Molay was burned at the stake in Paris and the history of the Templars came to an end until 1769 when they reappeared as part of the Masonic Fraternity.

There are a variety of theories on the Templars between 1314 and 1769. Some say they went underground or flourished in other countries. Others hold the Order perished. Since all of these remain in the realm of theories they are not included in this article.

THE PURPOSE OF TEMPLARY

Templary is founded upon the Christian Religion and the practice of the Christian virtues. It is a fraternal light that has illumined the world since the Crusades of 1099 to 1187 A.D. when stouthearted Knights of the Temple rescued and held Jerusalem and the Holy Places from the Infidel and protected poor unarmed Pilgrims who came all the way from Europe to worship at the Holy Shrine. The world has never witnessed any more unselfish service for God and humanity than that which was exemplified by those intrepid Crusaders. Nine centuries have rolled along and modern Knights Templar are the symbolic offspring of those fearless Crusaders. Today's Templars are likewise committed to tasks of exalted usefulness just as were their illustrious forebears many centuries ago.

The principles upon which the Orders of Knighthood are founded are expressed in Ritual and Symbolism and are founded upon the teachings of the Christian Religion. Templary is based upon the Holy Bible and extols the doctrine of human brotherhood and benevolence toward all mankind. It commends the reign of peace and glorifies the search for Divine Truth. It vows to draw its sword in defense of innocent maidens, destitute widows, helpless orphans, and the Christian Religion. It despises Communism and magnifies Freedom under law and constitutional government. It stands unswervingly for good morals and right living by each Knight Templar as an example of good citizenship in every community. Each Knight Templar has voluntarily professed the Fatherhood of God, the Brotherhood of Man, the immortality of the soul; and the love of Country. The Grand Standard of Templary contains a blood-red Passion Cross as the emblem which inspires every Templar to the highest ideals of the Christian Faith.

Templary is Masonry's answer to the call for Christian virtues in a world that needs a moral and religious renaissance. Templary is the recrudescence of the spirit of the Crusaders. Templary is America's hope of stimulating the community's conscience to stand up for God at a time when righteousness is desperately needed.

Let no Knight Templar underestimate the task that lies ahead, nor shrink from playing his part manfully. Let each of us recognize that it will be an uphill battle with worldly strife along the way. This should only add zest to acceptance of the challenge by red-blooded warriors.

However, in order to win, we must get back to the first principles! We must reconsecrate *our cause* to Christ, and the Christian religion - with all the sincerity we possess! There is no problem of our Order that cannot be solved by practicing our Christian profession more vigorously every day - all over the Templar world. Horizons must be raised, and perspectives must be lifted. When we do so, we shall put God back where He belongs in Templary, and we shall put Templary back where it belongs in the life of our day. In this spirit, we summon every Officer and Sir Knight to put on the whole armor of God as we march forth.

Templary is not solely a fraternal brotherhood. It is vastly more than that. When Masonry crosses the threshold of the Commandery, it becomes Christian, and we support the Christian Church in everyday life. We are endowed with a sense of mission which transcends all ordinary fraternal objectives. It is not enough to say that we "favor" ethics and good morals. The Orders of Knighthood require that we live up to the high calling of Christ in our lives; and that we support the Christian Church with all the zeal we possess. It is important at the outset that we put first things first!

Templary is Christian to the core - and we must never allow this fact to escape us for one instant. Our very reason for existence as an organization depends upon our observance of this central fact. Nothing is important in our Order that does not relate itself to Christ, the Christian Religion, and the Christian Church. Once we get the facts solidly planted in our minds and hearts we can plan our future. Until we become so immersed in our Christian cause that it becomes a part of our daily character as well as our very way of life we are not ready to start the journey. Unless Commandery leaders - at all levels - really take our allegiance to Christ seriously, they will find a trail of indifference, unconcern, and poor attendance - followed by a multitude of demits and even suspensions.

Our pledge of warfare against the deceits of the world is not allegorical but is very real, and for our lifetime! Let it be proclaimed that this warfare is not defensive, but aggressive. The righteous and benevolent influences of Templars and of our Commanderies is needed everywhere. Our influence in the form of our programs and projects is limited only by the devotion and resources of our members.

MODERN TEMPLAR GOVERNMENT

Templary alone, of all Masonic bodies in the United States with an open door, has a national organization with the necessary sovereign authority to effectively coordinate the efforts of all our members.

The Preamble of the Constitution of the Grand Encampment of Knights Templar of the U.S.A. reads - "We, the Knights Templar of the United States, in order to secure unity and better government and to increase the prosperity and influence of Templary, which is declared to comprise the Orders of Christian Knighthood known as Red Cross, Knight of Malta and Knight Templar, do ordain, and establish this Constitution."

Thus, by their own enactment, Knights Templar created their own controlling government. Knights Templar are governed in all of their activities:

- A. First by the Constitution, Statutes and Rituals of the Grand Encampment, and by the Orders and Decisions of the Grand Master;
- B. Second, by the Constitution, Laws and Regulations of their Grand Commandery, and by the Orders and Decisions of the Grand Commander;
- C. Third by the By-Laws of the Commandery of which they are members, and by the Orders of the Commander.

Between Triennial Conclaves, exclusive power is given to the Grand Master of the Grand Encampment

- to enforce the laws;
- to interpret the laws when necessary;
- to maintain a watchful supervision over all Commanderies, Grand, Constituent and Subordinate;
- to promote the general welfare of the Order and a host of other powers and duties.

Between Triennial Conclaves, the Grand Master has plenary power over the Grand Encampment. He may delegate a portion of his duties and authority to his Proxies, who are the Department Commanders, and others who may be appointed for specific occasions. Between Annual Conclaves authority rests with the Grand Commander within his Grand Commandery.

The third important level is the Eminent Commander and his Commandery. Templar laws are to be upheld by the Eminent Commander. Subject to this requirement, he should plan, promote, and be responsible for total effectiveness in response to the objectives of Templary of all Knights Templar within his Commandery. He should have within his concern the activity and involvement of every member, and seek to plan and accomplish programs which would demand the interest and effort of every member for the benefit of the community in which his Commandery is located. Also, it should be his concern to enlist others, not presently members, in the concerns of his Commandery's program.

TEMPLAR LEADERSHIP

Let us take a look at the all-important matter of Templar Leadership. Do we fully realize the great and lasting honor we have received by being entrusted with the leadership of our magnanimous order of Knighthood? Do we appreciate the true significance of our job to lead Knights Templar in our modern crusade for righteousness, morality, and the Christian religion?

While certain qualities have always been associated with ordinary leadership, Templar leadership requires qualifications which are vastly more demanding. Here are only a few!

A. A Sense of Christian Dedication

No Templar leader should start without re-dedicating himself to the cause of Christ. Every one of us must be wholly and completely "on Christ's team," in thought, word, and deed. Only when we indulge in soul-searching self-analysis can we be ready to begin the job of leading others in our great Christian cause. Templary's cause is Christ's cause, and any Templar who would lead our sacred cause must believe heart and soul in Christ's cause on earth.

B. A Proper Attitude

No matter how much we respect the other elements of "dedication" and "attitude," there is one more necessity for which there is no substitute, and that is work! Teddy Roosevelt once said: "Success is 10% inspiration and 90% perspiration." A leader can't succeed by being "on-and-off" the job. His efforts must be constant. He must be wholehearted in his devotion to his Commandery job. His Commandery must think of him as one who cares enough to sacrifice his time, effort, and pleasure to the cause he represents. When the rank and file get this image, he becomes their leader in reality and not merely by having been installed.

C. Intelligent Imagination

A leader must use his God-given intelligence and imagination to put work on the Trestle Board for his Sir Knights to perform. Templary is full of projects which will benefit any community where a Commandery is located. Each Commandery should select at least one Templar project and adopt it for its own this year and each succeeding year. Any leader with the will to succeed can go over a checklist of dozens of Templar projects and get things "off-center," if he will only give the word.

D. The Selection of Our Leaders

The selection of our leaders is the personal responsibility of every member entitled to vote. He ought to understand that the selection of leadership in Templary is as sacred an act as anything he will ever perform. Templary will advance only through the selection of our best leaders. Selection should never be made on the basis of friendship, availability, or "someone who has time on his hands."

- a. Let us inquire in each instance when we consider a candidate for Templar office:
 1. Does he have a sense of Christian dedication?
 2. Does he have an attitude which is aggressive and forward-looking, which will attract the support of others?
 3. Is he willing to work?
 4. Will he use intelligence and imagination in setting up an active and interesting program?

5. Will he give "all he has" to his Templar job if elected?
6. Is he well-informed as to the purposes of Templary and committed to its advancement?
7. Will he adopt goals to be achieved and formulate plans for their accomplishment?

D. The Length of Officer Lines

How long should the lines be? Election of Commanders, in practice, occurs several years before the final year of command. By custom, the officer expects to continue through the entire line to the top. The interval varies widely from a few years up to as many as ten years. Thus, the question is asked today in many places, "How long should the lines be?" Grand Encampment requires that the first four officers of Grand Commanderies and the first three officers of Commanderies be chosen by election and permits the remaining officers, except the Treasurers and Recorders, to be either elected or appointed as may be prescribed by the Grand Commanderies. The present trend is clearly toward shorter lines.

E. The Scope of Leadership

Obviously, in no situation is leadership a one-man job. In addition to the prescribed officers, a variety of committees is needed. The usual ones are those in the areas of finance, ritualistic instruction and performance, social occasions, and as previously suggested by Grand Encampment, committees on membership, public relations, religious activities, Knights Templar Eye Foundation, Knights Templar Educational Loan Foundation, Patriotic and Civic Activities, and several others. In the average Commandery, each of these areas might best be served by a committee of three members. In the very small Commandery, some might be combined. In the very large Commandery, more and larger committees might be named.

It is the purpose of this brochure to provide sufficient information concerning all of the natural activity areas of Templary so that a Commander may be so basically informed that he may proceed, having intimate knowledge of the Commandery roster and of the abilities and interests of all members, to plan the program to be accomplished during his administration and the organization which will serve these plans best.

The best way to make such plans is in conjunction with the other dais officers who are equally interested and involved and with the Recorder. Together, these four usually form what may be called the Executive Committee. They not only plan together but are closely associated in the execution of the plan and in periodic review.

The best time to form such plans is several months before the beginning of the new Commandery administration.

LEADERSHIP IN CONSTITUENT COMMANDERIES

Just as the Commander of an Army depends upon the troops in the front line to bring victory, so does the Grand Encampment depend upon the rank-and-file of Knights Templar in the local community to win the battle for Templary. Unless Knights Templar at the "grassroots" level are keenly interested and pursue Grand Encampment policies with vigor and dispatch, victory will not perch on our Beauceant.

The Grand Encampment fully understands this situation and wants to emphasize the importance of the local Commandery. It is vital that the leadership of Constituent Commanderies should be in good hands, under active, qualified leaders. Also, it is supremely necessary that the local Commandery should be a positive force for good in the community and so recognized by its citizens as well as fellow Templars. The answer lies in local leadership.

The battle to build Templary will be won or lost at the local level. The best plans are fruitless unless carried into execution by good leaders at the "grassroots" level.

Until they are carried out by local leaders, the finest plans of top officers will fall flat. Therefore, we must improve the quality of local leadership and inspire Commanders to carry out plans which will strengthen the whole fabric of Templary.

Leadership is doubly important in Masonry because members of the Craft are trained to look up to the Worshipful Master and wait for him to put his instructions on the Trestle Board, inasmuch as Masonic discipline requires complete and unquestioning respect for the Master. If the Master falters, there is "confusion among the workmen." To an even greater degree is this true in the Commandery, a semi-military organization, where orders are expected to be given by the Commander and carried out with alacrity.

Here are just a few of the qualities of leadership we so badly need:

A. Sense of Devotion

A leader must be completely "sold" on his cause; he must be so thoroughly convinced himself that he can convince others, and he must not have even a wavering doubt as to the merits of his cause.

B. Factual Equipment

A leader must be an arsenal of information about his cause, he must get all the facts and know all there is to learn about it, and he must be able to justify his cause everywhere and before all men.

C. Aggressiveness

A leader must have that extra quality of aggressiveness, he must remember that enthusiasm begets enthusiasm, and he must demonstrate an attitude of quiet assurance that instills confidence.

D. Hard Work

A leader must be willing to set the pace for all who follow his lead, he must be willing to work harder and longer than anyone else, and he must convince his followers that they can succeed by following him.

As we choose our Templar leaders for the fateful years ahead, let us try to select those who will be the best for Templary, regardless of their personalities. Only then will we have a clear

conscience. When line officers, after a reasonable time, fail to measure up, they should be privately encouraged to step aside or should be passed over. No man can afford to make a failure of the office of Commander. Of course, this is a delicate matter, but it is too important to "sweep under the rug."

Let's face the bare truth-we need to improve Templary by selecting the best leaders we can find. Only then will we go forward "full steam." Progress can be achieved only with the finest leadership available.

The Grand Encampment publishes "Guidelines for Junior Officers," available without charge on request from the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

GUIDELINES for THE JUNIOR OFFICERS of a COMMANDERY

“Interest, Knowledge
Enthusiasm, Service
prepare for. ...”



Leadership

Reissued - October 1990

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Most Eminent Grand Master
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Guidelines for Junior Officers

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Introduction ...

These recommendations and observations, as a Grand Encampment service for Commandery officers, have been prepared under the direction of the Grand Master, and executed through the office of the Grand Recorder.

Copies are available from that office free of charge for all present and prospective officers of a Commandery of Knights Templar.

As a point of information, it is noted that the guidelines primarily are in the form of suggestions and that specific application may vary from Commandery to Commandery.

The multiple-theme, however, is constant and unalterable for any Sir Knight now serving or aspiring to serve as a Templar officer: INTEREST, DESIRE, KNOWLEDGE, INVOLVEMENT, CONSISTENT SERVICE IN A CHRISTIAN CAUSE, and LEADERSHIP.

TO THE JUNIOR OFFICERS OF A COMMANDERY

As an elected Junior Officer of your Commandery, you have good reason to believe that you will progress through the lines until you attain the highest honor and assume the greatest responsibility your Commandery can confer - the rewarding and demanding attributes of an Eminent Commander. To be worthy of that honor should be the aim of every officer who appreciates the value of Christian Masonry and understands his Commandery's contributory role in the Templar structure.

LOOKING AHEAD

The duties of your present office should be well known to you and should be executed to the best of your ability. Additionally, it is of vital importance that you look ahead and prepare yourself with diligence and dedication to the time when your fellow Sir Knights will elect you to executive leadership of your Commandery. The duties of a Commander are as numerous as they are important. They extend far beyond the conferral of the Orders and the conducting of the Conclaves.

It is, however, within the capabilities of every Eminent Commander who has prepared himself in advance to perform those duties with zeal and distinction if he realizes that his primary function is to serve Templars and Templary and if he has become fully acquainted with the demands for this once-in-a-lifetime experience and opportunity.

This booklet of comments and recommendations is dedicated to you as a Junior officer with the hope that it will be of assistance to you during your preparatory years. The booklet emphasizes two major points - first, fulfilling the needs of your present office willingly and effectively; second, preparing yourself in every way for your future duties, powers, responsibilities, and privileges.

WHAT TO EXPECT

When you become Eminent Commander of a Commandery of Knights Templar you must preside and you must govern. It will behoove you to be careful and considerate so that your conduct and your decisions are both wise and just. and that they will need to be made "on the spur of the moment" without the opportunity to receive counsel and advice from others. There will be instances where the circumstances cannot be foreseen. However, the majority of decisions to be made can be anticipated with proper study and knowledge, thus giving you time to prepare.

It is impossible to stress the importance of preparation too strongly. The need for personal preparation is an obvious and fundamental fact. Long before you are about to become Eminent Commander, you should study and become thoroughly acquainted with the Constitution and Statutes of the Grand Encampment of the United States of America, the laws and regulations of your Grand Commandery and the By-Laws of your own Commandery. Do not wait to apply zeal and diligence until the time arrives for you to be elected Commander.

QUALIFICATIONS

The qualifications of an Eminent Commander are Masonic, Templar and Personal. Each man elected to this station should have those virtues which are normally associated with a Christian member of the Masonic Fraternity.

He should be moral and upright before God and of good repute before the world, obedient to the moral law, holding the deepest respect and confidence of his fellow men. He should know the ritualistic work and be able to teach it.

Above all, he should either be, or train himself to be, an efficient executive in order to properly preside and conduct all the affairs incumbent upon the individual elected to head his Commandery. Ritual conferrals can be assigned; executive leadership cannot.

He should be familiar with the tools provided him by the Grand Encampment - the variety of guidelines on such subjects as Membership, Religious Activities, Patriotic and Civic Activities, Public Relations, the Knights Templar Educational Foundation - and, to remain current and well-informed, the Knight Templar Magazine. These written materials give you valuable information, directly and

indirectly, and will be particularly helpful in your selection of Sir Knights in guiding and directing them in the various committees it will be your duty to form.

THE COMMANDER AS AN EXAMPLE

No one man can be expected to possess all the desirable personal traits, but an Eminent Commander should have quite definite personal qualifications. Some, if not already possessed, can be acquired. It must be remembered that every Sir Knight is a mirror for Templary, but none reflects the presence or lack of Christian principles so graphically as the Templar who serves as Eminent Commander. What he says and what he does can make a tremendous difference in what the Order means to others, both inside and out of the asylum. He can attract or repel by personal example.

PLANNING

The length of time you will have for preparation varies among the different Commanderies, but it is recommended that you always keep a minimum of "one year ahead" in your study and in your planning. This may seem like an unnecessary injunction to many who are serving in the Commandery line because it is so obvious and logical. However, as you perhaps may have observed, there are instances where a Knight Templar reaches a certain station, either that of Commander or of a Junior officer, without having a knowledgeable conception of what the office entails until he is elected.

In business and commercial activity, especially if the individual knows he is going to be regularly advanced, learning the next man's job would be a mandatory and obvious practice. Templary deserves the same kind of consideration - or more. Look ahead as far as possible and become as familiar with the aspects of Commandery operations as possible. When you become Generalissimo,

you have just one year in which to make your final preparations for the important year of Commander. Your term as Generalissimo can be especially productive in making your next year successful and rewarding. Use the time during this last year fully and wisely and your efforts will reap a rich dividend for you, for your Commandery, and for Templary in general.

APPOINTMENTS - WHO AND HOW

When Generalissimo, give particular time and attention to those you will select as appointed officers and committee chairmen and members. Appointments should be made with the utmost care, bearing in mind that you need more than friendship to support you in your work for the Commandery. You need good and faithful officers and committee members to achieve Commandery progress. Also, remember that some of the men you select may advance ultimately to the office of Commander. Therefore, use unbiased judgment in your selections.

You should not be influenced by politics, friendship, "mercenary or any other improper motive" in planning your appointments. As a Templar your appointees should demonstrate among other characteristics these qualities:

- regular church attendance,
- exemplification of the highest type of knighthood,
- punctual in engagements,
- ardently interested in Templar activities,
- capable of mixing with fellow Sir Knights,
- have some ritualistic abilities and, especially,
- a potential for executive leadership.

Obviously, as a Knight Templar, your appointment should be also charitable, humane, kind, considerate, and diplomatic - as well as practical.

Here is one suggested method of developing your slate of appointments in a pleasant and harmonious manner: First, make your list of appointees and their respective offices, then several months before your election - possibly before a Stated Conclave - arrange a dinner (perhaps a "Dutch Treat" affair) at the Temple or in a nearby restaurant where you can have a private room for discussion. To this dinner invite your Commander, Captain General, Recorder, and the active Past Commanders.

During or following the dinner, for their information, consideration, and comment, present the name of each appointee, and his office, one by one. Listen to the comments and suggestions. Be ready to detect any possible objections that may be caused by improper motives, but, above all, listen for the viewpoints and the expressions of Templar opinion. When you have gone through the list, considering each name separately, you will have received an educated evaluation of the individuals you have planned to appoint. If you receive agreement from this group, you will have surmounted an important hurdle and will have made a most significant gain in cooperation and support.

Later, but still well in advance of the election, a second dinner would be helpful of the same general type. This time, invite the Commander, Captain General, Recorder, and all of your tentative appointees. On this occasion you should briefly but directly state precisely what you and the Commandery will expect from each person to be appointed, stressing such particular items as punctuality, efficiency, obedience to the rules and regulations, consistency of performance, an understanding of the value and need for "programs of continuity" and a matching desire, with you, to plan and work not only during your term but to project programs and ideas for the continued progress of your Commandery.

When each appointee has indicated his acceptance of the proffered office or committee appointment and has obligated himself to be present for installation, you are ready to make your official appointments upon your election to the post of Eminent Commander.

A Commander generally can appoint such special committees as he feels will help the Commandery maintain interest and participation and make progress in the basic needs of Christian Masonry. Additionally, there are a number of committees which are strictly required and which are quite essential to the well being of the Commandery and of Templary.

In selecting Sir Knights for your committees, guard against the automatic naming of the most active Knights. Your selection should be made from the entire roster of members, choosing those who have special talents along the lines required by the work to be performed by the committee. Too often we overlook those Sir Knights who are sometimes "just waiting" to be asked to do something and whose talents, if studied, would show that they can contribute much to your Commandery.

Frequently a member will become enthusiastic because you have given him incentive and because he may have received for the first time as a Templar an opportunity to use his talent and to contribute to a project in which he has convincing belief. In general, pick the persons you believe are the most capable and the most willing to carry out the work of the Commandery, but be sure to keep looking for those supposedly "inactive" Templars who might suddenly become active if you give them something worthwhile to do.

COMMITTEES THAT CONTRIBUTE

Undoubtedly the most important committee you will appoint is the Committee on Membership. Ideally, this committee should consist of Sir Knights who are active in each Lodge, Chapter, Council, Consistory and Shrine Temple in the area served by your Commandery. The size of this Committee is governed by the needs of your Commandery and your own considered judgment as to whether a small and compact committee or a large and diversified committee would be the more productive. Either way, it must have as Chairman an active Mason who will not allow the members of the committee to forget or neglect their duty to the Commandery.

Other committee membership requirements are sometimes apparent. Examples: the Religious Activities Committee should be comprised of Templars who are ministers, lay leaders, and others interested in religious programming and observance; the Patriotic and Civic Activities Committee should include judges, municipal officials, members of the police, civic leaders, and others who have shown interest and concern in community activities; school men, youth workers and those with some knowledge of young people and education generally will make the most appropriate members of the Knights Templar Educational Foundation Committee.

The Knights Templar Eye Foundation Committee could be composed of such persons as doctors, welfare workers or others who have concern and knowledge of the public's need and the Foundation's operations.

One of the most important committees at any level is the Committee on Public Relations. Almost every activity can be hindered or helped by the personnel on your Public Relations Committee. Make use of this committee not only for the usual kind of newspaper, radio and

television "publicity," but also to help promote among your own members your various programs and projects for the year. In other words, the work of the Committee on Public Relations applies both internally and externally. To be most helpful, the membership should include newspapermen, photographers, writers, speakers, and others who are acquainted with or have a flair for self-expression generally and whose contact with members and the public will represent Templary not only with dedication but also with intelligence.

THE COMMANDER AS PROGRAMMER

Since you are not appointing these committees simply to fill the roster of appointments, it becomes quite clear that your first and foremost consideration is to plan your program for your year as Commander. You should not necessarily go off on a tangent just to be different from your predecessors, but if changes are needed you should try to institute them. It is to be remembered, however, that no one man in one year can change the entire course of the Commandery. You need "continuity" in your theme and in your programming for the year, the kind of continuity that will foster a continuance, through consultation and agreement among your Junior Officers, of projects for years to come.

Interesting programs for all Stated Conclaves are extremely important. You need to plan programs that will attract and inspire members to be present. Once your membership becomes aware that the Commander has arranged a series of truly worthwhile programs for the year's Conclaves, you will find attendance automatically increasing. Planning programs of this type takes serious thought lots of work and the cooperation of your fellow officers and committee members. It is something that cannot be done "as you go," but must be planned well in advance.

It is suggested that at the beginning of his term of office, the Eminent Commander should know what his programs will be specifically for at least the next six months - preferably for the full year. It is especially important, both for your own benefit and that of the Commandery, that your other officers be kept well informed of your plans and your aims. In other words, you as Commander should plan your work and work your plan, and keep the Junior Officers so well advised that they could keep the plans in operation if something should prevent the attendance of the Commander at any Conclaves.

In selecting programs for your Conclaves you will find a wide and diversified field. Those which are herein enumerated and briefly described are only a few. Your own ingenuity and imaginative ability will find many others which might be particularly helpful in your Commandery. Please remember that these are only suggestions and that you are encouraged to seek others.

1. **Anniversaries:** An anniversary program might commemorate the granting of a charter or some other special event in the history of your Commandery. The celebration could take the form of a dinner meeting or appropriate ceremonies in the asylum - or both.
2. **Past Commanders Night:** For such an occasion an Order could be conferred with a Past Commander in each station. Different Past Commanders could be designated to speak briefly on their recollections of Commandery activities of the past. A Memorial Service could be held for deceased Past Commanders.
3. **Patriarchs Night:** This could be a program to salute members who are 70 years or more of age, or those with 25 or 50 years of membership as a Templar, all of whom could be invited

guests at a dinner or meeting in their honor. One, perhaps two or more, could be scheduled to speak in the open Commandery.

4. Class Night: On this night each Past Commander would be asked to have present as many as possible of the members who were Knighted during his year as Commander. There could be a special "blue ribbon" award for the Past Commander having the greatest percentage (or number) present of those Knighted during his year.
5. Open Forum: Select three or four well-informed Sir Knights to form a panel to answer any questions on Templary. This may be a difficult assignment for the panel, but it does create interest and it does result in the dissemination of some helpful information. The questions could come from a "question box" set up in the anteroom for several Conclaves prior to this particular night, or cards or sheets of paper could be distributed at the opening of the Conclave so that any member could jot down questions which might be in his mind. These could then be collected and presented to the panel by a Moderator, who probably should be a Grand Commandery officer or an Inspection officer. It may be necessary to have a few "planted questions," especially if you are planning for the questions to come from the floor.
6. Recognitions: There is always an opportunity to give well-deserved recognition to some member or members, particularly those who have achieved honor and recognition in Templary, in Masonry, in charities, or in the general community. Honor those who have been of service to DeMolay, to Job's Daughters, or Rainbow Girls. Honor those members who are Knights of the York Cross of Honour. And certainly, recipients of the Knights Templar Cross of Honor should be recognized in their own Commandery.
7. Sojourners Night: Set aside one of your Conclaves to specifically invite the attendance of Templars who live in the vicinity but who are not members of your particular Commandery. In addition to the general good fellowship this engenders, it is quite possible that you will help to reactivate some Templar who hesitates to project himself but will respond to a personal invitation.
8. Invitation Night: On this night Templars from a local industry could be invited to attend as a group. They may be from an oil refinery, from a railroad, from a steel mill, from a manufacturing plant, law offices, or from any one of a number of enterprises. One of the benefits is that it enables the individuals to become acquainted with members of other Commanderies with whom they may be associated in their places of employment. Assemble them in the anteroom and admit them as a group. There is a wide range of opportunity for this type of activity. Perhaps one of the group could be scheduled as a guest speaker for the evening.
9. Father and Son Night and/or Kin Night: This one calls for an invitation to go to each father-and-son combination in your Commandery or in the general Templar area. Each such combination attending could be recognized and honored in some fashion. If the father-and-son combinations would not appear to attract a sufficient number to make a program, you may wish to broaden the scope and extend an invitation to a "family combination" within Templary. These might include fathers, sons, brothers, nephews, uncles, son-in-laws, brothers-in-law - and even including cousins if you wish! The family combination having the greatest number present should be especially recognized or perhaps an award given to the senior member of any of the families present.
10. Personal Anniversary of Knighting: Certainly, every Commandery should recognize the "Templar Birthday" of each Sir Knight. To accomplish this, it is recommended that the Recorder be requested to notify each member whose Knighting anniversary occurs during

the month and ask him to be present for the Conclave of the month. The Eminent Commander should plan a special acknowledgment and appropriate tribute to each of those members who are present during their personal anniversary month.

These are but a few of the possibilities. One of the determining factors in the success of any program, whether one of those suggested or one of your own selection, is proper and adequate promotion among the Commandery membership. Your Committee on Public Relations can assist you in this respect, but there are other ways and means of communicating with your membership to encourage their attendance. Give them as much advance notice as possible, and give it to them frequently. The fact that you announce an event once may seem sufficient to you but "advertising" to be successful must also be repetitious. Do your announcing and communicating in a variety of ways. And be sure to delegate specified details to other members so that everything is in readiness for your programs well in advance of the Conclaves themselves. Nothing – but nothing - should be left to be done at the last minute.

THE COMMANDER AS PRESIDING OFFICER

In conducting your Conclaves, keep these elementary rules in mind:

1. - Start on time.
2. - Close at a reasonable hour.
3. - Between the start and the close, have something "special" in the way
4. of Conclave program.
5. - Preside with consideration but with authority.
6. - Show friendliness and concern for your fellow members.
7. - Foster good fellowship during refreshment and social periods.

One of the most illogical statements heard in the majority of Commanderies is, "We have always done it that way." Perhaps in some instances, there is a very good reason for doing something in a particular way, and perhaps the reason has been forgotten. On the other hand, it is quite possible that "we do it that way" because a better way has never been found. Let's look for that better way.

Changes should not be made for the sake of change, but if there is something you can do to improve your Conclaves or your attendance, give it careful consideration - then, if you are convinced. try it!

Not everyone is a born leader but everyone can develop interest and enthusiasm and can learn the essentials of leadership if you remember that others would like to work with you if you are optimistic and enthusiastic, if you are capable of instilling the desire to support and cooperate in your plans for the Commandery. The major purpose of a Commander is not to win a popularity contest but, on the other hand, he can accomplish far more if he is thoughtful, considerate, understanding, and pleasant with others. Keep in mind that teamwork is essential in everything you do, not only in Templary.

As Commander, don't lose your enthusiasm if things do not go "just right." Don't give up too quickly! In this respect, Templary is no different from business or daily life. You must learn to expect some reverses, but you must also learn to strive consistently and determinedly toward your goals.

Most likely, you will have some members of the committees, some officers, and others who will disappoint you from time to time, but do not let that disappointment become discouragement. And remember, the more thought you give to your selections or appointments, the more cooperation and assistance you are going to receive from the appointees.

No Commandery, or any other organization, can endure without acquiring new members nor can it thrive unless these new members are assimilated. Well-conceived programs can be a great help in the assimilation process. Make every new member familiar with these surroundings, acquaint him with his fellow Sir Knights, stimulate his interest and his enthusiasm, and keep him informed on Templar activities and projects. Only then will he become a working Templar and a real asset to your Commandery. Before he can be truly "sold" on our Order, he must see and recognize the beauty and truth of Templary.

This goal is worthy of your every effort as Eminent Commander .

... AND FINALLY

Good work - and good luck!

DEPARTMENT COMMANDERS

AND DEPARTMENT WORKSHOPS

The Constitution of the Grand Encampment wisely provides for Department Commanders who shall represent the Grand Master in each of their Departments and who shall be his personal Proxy. The country is divided into seven Departments, each one consisting of several Grand Commanderies. Section 29(a) of the Constitution of the Grand Encampment provides in part: " . . . whose duties shall include the status of Proxy of the Grand Master within such Department on all occasions when the Grand Master or other Special Proxy is not present. Such Department Commander shall be under the immediate direction of the Grand Master, and shall perform such duties as he may direct."

Thus, the Department Commander is given the broadest kind of power and is the alter ego of the Grand Master within his Department- "to do and perform all such acts as he may deem for the interest of Templary and which are not contrary to the Constitution, Statutes and Regulations of the Grand Encampment." The Department Commander is the right arm of the Grand Master.

The importance of the office of Department Commander is evidenced by the fact that a Department Commander ranks immediately below the Grand Encampment line officers, the Grand Treasurer, the Grand Recorder, and the Grand Prelate, and ahead of all other members of the Grand Encampment. If the Department Commander appears as the official representative of the Grand Master, he will be entitled, as his official representative, to the honors usually accorded the Grand Master himself and will speak with his voice.

Each Department Commander is expected to take the initiative in arranging and conducting an Annual Department Conference, following approval of the arrangements, agenda, and date by the Grand Master. These conferences are usually called Department "Workshops" in recognition of the purpose to be served and the fact that this name lends itself to a hard-working group of Dais Officers and Past Grand Commanders trying to solve mutual problems of great importance to Templary.

The Department Commander is expected to work continuously with the officers of his several Grand Commanderies in the promotion of the several action programs. Thus, it is vitally necessary that the Department Commander shall be very familiar with the work and recommendations of all of the Grand Encampment Officers and Committees and see that these ideas and policies are communicated to the Dais Officers of the Grand Commanderies of his Department. He is also expected to keep in close touch with the functioning of the Grand Commanderies of his Department and to advise the Grand Master from time to time as to the status of programs in each of his Grand Commanderies. He is expected to pursue each of the policies of the Grand Encampment and to have general supervision of all Templar affairs of his Department.

COMMITTEES

The Statutes of the Grand Encampment call for 15 Standing Committees to be appointed by the Grand Master and to serve at his discretion during the Triennial. The function of each of these Standing Committees is set forth in the Statutes.

The 15 Standing Committees are:

1. Templar Jurisprudence,
2. Finance,
3. Foreign Relations,
4. Printing,
5. Religious Activities,
6. Necrology,
7. Triennial Conclave,
8. the Educational Foundation,
9. the Knights Templar Eye Foundation,
10. Drill Regulations,
11. Triennial Conclave Expense,
12. Ritualistic Matters,
13. Membership,
14. Patriotic and Civic Activities,
15. Public Relations.

The Statutes also call for a Special Committee on Dispensations and Charters with specific duties outlined.

Additional Special Committees may be appointed by the Grand Master to serve a special need. These Special Committees are appointed by the Grand Master each Triennium as long as a need for them exists.

Special Committees include, or have included, the following:

- York Rite Unity,
- DeMolay,
- Publication
- Spanish Language Ritual,
- Templar History,-
- Knights Templar Cross of Honor Award,
- George Washington Memorial Chapel,
- Easter Sunrise Memorial Service.

The Standing Committees meet during the Triennial Conclave and at other times and places on approval of the Grand Master.

The Committee Advisory to the Grand Master is composed of all elected officers, past and present, the Department Commanders, and the Chairman of each of the Standing Committees. This Committee usually meets annually with the Grand Master to assist and advise on the general workings of the Grand Encampment.

The Statutes also name five Conclave Committees to be appointed by the Grand Master to serve for the Triennial Conclave. These Committees are:

- Credentials,
- Division and Reference,
- Grievances,
- Time and Place of Next Conclave,
- Unfinished Business.

Their duties are laid down in the Statutes. The Grand Master has the power to appoint any other Conclave Committees which he deems necessary.

EFFECTS OF TEMPLARY IN THE 20th CENTURY

THE KNIGHTS TEMPLAR EYE FOUNDATION, INC.

A genuine concern for the needs of others is one of the basic characteristics of Templary - being Christian in nature, and stemming from the ancient Hospitallers or Knights of Malta. First in importance and national in scope is the Knights Templar Eye Foundation, Inc. This great project represents every Knight Templar of the United States and requires his attention and understanding.

- A. History and Operation of the Knight Templar Eye Foundation, Inc. The Knights Templar Eye Foundation, Inc., was founded by action taken at the Triennial Conclave of 1955, and the organization was formed in 1957. The management of the Foundation is in the hands of its Board of Trustees. The administration of the Eye Foundation is in the hands of the Executive Director. Each Grand Commandery should have an active, wide-awake, and alert Eye Foundation Committee to work with the Executive Director. Each Constituent Commandery should also have a vigorous committee to work with the state committee and with the Executive Director.

No paid solicitors have ever been employed. All funds are raised by voluntary contributions and the contributions received from contributing and cooperating Divisions - together with an annual assessment of each Knight Templar. No salaries are paid to anyone, except the necessary staff in the national office. No funds are used for the construction of hospital facilities. Hence, nearly all funds received are available for research or surgery. All contributions are tax-deductible. The Knights Templar Eye Foundation may be justly designated as one of the world's greatest humanitarian projects. Money has been allocated to research in college and university laboratories for the study of diseases causing blindness. Many thousands of cases have been processed. Millions have been expended for surgical and hospital expenses. But such figures as these lack substance until we remember that each of these thousands was a person - a fellow human - who lacked both personal resources and access to any publicly supported program which would enable him to have the surgical treatment to ward off or correct the actual condition of blindness, which has been certified by a medical specialist. Our files are full of testimonial letters, in every one of which the person brought from darkness to light by our efforts has expressed his glowing appreciation to God and His Christian Knights for their generous assistance. Surely this is doing the work of the Master.

- B. There would be a Knight Templar Eye Foundation Committee in every Commandery. There should be within each Commandery a special Knight Templar Eye Foundation Committee composed of interested and dedicated Knights Templar. Such a Committee is necessary for two reasons,
- (1) the Knights Templar Eye Foundation, already a proud success, may continue to grow and may touch persons in every community, and
 - (2) 14 Templars in every Commandery may experience the joy of useful service on a person-to-person basis, which is always much more satisfactory than the simple contribution of money.
- C. Committee Functions.

1. To become informed. Full information on the operation of the Knight Templar Eye Foundation, in the form of brochures, etc., should be obtained through the Grand Commandery Committee. A set of forms should be obtained from the Grand Commandery Committee so that the application may be forwarded with all dispatch.
2. To inform others. Our own Knights Templar should know the facts about what we have done and what we stand ready to do for persons without personal resources who face blindness. Doctors, surgeons, and especially Ophthalmologists in every city, town, and hamlet in the country should be informed by the Knights Templar and kept informed about the progress of our great charity. Where committees have been most active, they have appeared on scores of occasions before Blue Lodges and other Masonic Bodies within their jurisdiction, before service clubs, professional societies, church organizations, industrial, and business organizations. From this activity comes not only the reference of patients, but due recognition of the magnificent contributions being made by Templary.
3. To assist those in need. The application forms are not complicated; neither is the procedure. However, it is best that the forms be on hand and fully understood, as certain information is essential and is to be verified so that we can be sure that the need of our assistance is real and within our limitations. It is best that the forms be completed with the assistance of the local committeeman, who then as the Knight Templar sponsor may quickly satisfy himself that the incidental statements are true and that recourse to public assistance is not available. Not only is handling of the case expedited, but the personal participation of the committeeman shows the applicant, as well as the public, that we handle these cases with promptness and dispatch.
4. To assist in raising funds. The local committee should see that the persons and organizations who might wish to help the Knight Templar Eye Foundation are fully informed about the work. We receive additional contributions from:
 - a. Voluntary contributions and memorial gifts. Many of our members have means and the habit of giving - a letter to every member or a reminder in the Commandery bulletin will be revealing. In many places, members habitually contribute as a memorial to deceased Templars. The solicitation of such memorials as a Commandery project, within its membership, might well be a part of the memorial service if conducted separately, or at the next conclave, or in the next bulletin. Acknowledgment receipts are sent from the Eye Foundation for all contributions.
 - b. Wills and bequests. Many persons, both within and outside 15 Templary, are financially able and charitably inclined. They need to be told about the Knights Templar Eye Foundation so that at the appropriate time they may include our project in their Will. Certainly, every attorney and banker within our jurisdiction should be informed, together with all who might be inclined to recommend the Knight Templar Eye Foundation at the right time. No one can realize how much it means to drop a good word at the right time so that the individual may remember the Knight Templar Eye Foundation in his will.
 - c. Life Sponsors. Any Knight Templar may become a Life Sponsor of the Eye Foundation upon a single payment of \$30.00. A Life Sponsor card goes to the member together with a receipt, and he is relieved from the annual

assessment. Two copies of the receipt go to the Grand Recorder one of which is forwarded to the Commandery, so that appropriate record may be made. Many Knights Templar are now Life Sponsors - many more would result if all could be informed.

- d. Patron and Associate Patrons. Any individual, not a member, or any small organization, whether Masonic or not, may join by contributions. A single donation of \$100, or more, entitles the individual or organization to classification as a Patron of the Eye Foundation, and \$50, or more, qualifies him or them as an Associate Patron, and a suitable certificate is sent in recognition of the gift. Members, too, may become Patrons or Associate Patrons which also relieves them of the annual assessment.
- e. Grand Commander's and Grand Master's Clubs. Any individual (not exclusively Knights Templar) may contribute to the immediate and ongoing needs of the Eye Foundation by joining either of these Clubs. To become a member of the Grand Commander's Club, individuals make an initial gift donation of \$100, and the pledge of minimum annual donations of \$100. When a total of \$1,000 has been donated, membership is transferred to the Grand Master's Club. Immediate membership in the Grand Master's Club is achieved upon receipt of a one-time contribution of \$1,000. Grand Commander's Club "special benefactors" receive numbered wallet cards, and Grand Master's Club members are recognized with a personalized bronze desk plaque and metal wallet card. Contributions are tax-deductible and provide no Commandery credit.
- f. Grand and Coordinate bodies participation. Our first full endorsement came from the Social Order of the Beauceant, which has associated with .us for several years and has contributed hundreds of thousands of dollars to our funds. Such support shows how others throughout the country view the importance of our great humanitarian project.
- g. Commandery fund-raising. In recognition of the obvious fact that those things done officially by our Commanderies need little supervision, local Commanderies are now permitted to raise money for the Knights Templar Eye Foundation by any or all usually accepted methods, providing only that
 - (1). The decision to hold a particular program is made in a regular Conclave of the Commandery, and
 - (2). that 100% of the net receipts are forwarded to the Eye Foundation office within thirty days afterward.
- h. Voluntary Activities Campaign. Each year, for a specified period, all Commanderies are asked to cooperate in a special drive to raise money for the Eye Foundation. Emphasis is placed on fund-raising activities rather than personal contributions. Special recognition is given by the Grand Encampment to Grand, Constituent, and Subordinate Commanderies reaching a specified level of participation.

The Grand Encampment feels that the Knights Templar Eye Foundation is doing such an outstanding job for humanity that every Knight Templar ought to become an enthusiastic booster. We ought to be talking to our friends more often about its wonderful work. Truly this is the work of our Savior.

THE KNIGHTS TEMPLAR EDUCATIONAL FOUNDATION

In 1922 the Grand Encampment launched the Knights Templar Educational Foundation with these words:

"We feel that the Grand Encampment can build no greater monument nor inaugurate a more worthwhile movement than to put into effect a plan which will provide educational advantages for the youth of our beloved Country, thereby enabling them to become more useful members of society and better citizens of this Republic."

Knights Templar was the first fraternal order to establish a program to assist needy young men and women to complete a higher education. The money was raised by transferring \$100,000 from our Permanent Fund, augmented by a levy upon each Knight Templar of one dollar per year for nine years. Loans have been made to individual students in the amount of over \$32 million. The Foundation maintains a revolving fund of approximately \$6 million, invested in student loans to the extent of approximately 75 percent. This proud record will stand up favorably when compared with any similar project anywhere.

The Knights Templar Educational Foundation publishes its general rules in a pamphlet called "Regulations and Standard Practice."

Among these –

- (1) "Loans may be granted for vocational, professional training, advanced degree or post-graduate work upon written approval of the majority of the Division (State) Committee;
- (2) the maximum loan will be \$2,500 when one scholastic year is required to complete the course, \$2,500 per year when two scholastic years are required to complete the course, a maximum of \$5,000 to any one student;
- (3) loans shall be evidenced by a negotiable note and agreement for the amount loaned bearing interest at the minimum rate of 5% per annum from a time not later than the date of graduation or leaving college;
- (4) each applicant shall be 17 carefully and thoroughly investigated by the Committee or Constituent Commandery Committee;
- (5) minimum repayments shall be 10% during the first year after the date of graduation, 20% during the second year, 30% during the third year, and 40% during the fourth year."

The Grand Encampment Committee says:

"It is recommended and urged that each Constituent Commandery appoint a committee of not less than three from its membership, for the purpose of acting in a liaison capacity between the State Committee and the local Commandery. This committee should cooperate in all matters pertaining to the Foundation in their community. They should publicize the policies of the Foundation, furnish information on eligibility of applicants, and assist in making investigations."

To this official language, we would add these practical suggestions:

The local committee should be composed of members who have active and sympathetic contacts with young people within their jurisdiction, especially with DeMolay and other Masonic-related groups. Information should go to school officials, our own members, and other Masonic

bodies. The local committee should have in hand the basic application form and be ready to assist any worthy student in its preparation. At the same time, it should be ready to make such primary local investigations as might be desired by the State Committee, thus expediting the loan process. In the event that repayment might later become delinquent, the local committee should assist the Division Committee as needed.

The Grand Encampment prints a "Guidelines for Making Student Loans" - available without charge from the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

Much remains to be done to publicize our Knights Templar Educational Foundation and to make its benefit known to institutions and to the public. The main thrust in this direction must come from the membership itself. Each Templar should become acquainted with the procedures for securing loans so that he is in a better position to answer questions and to refer reputable applications. The local Recorder is in the best position to furnish information. If more details are needed, write to the Chairman of the Committee on the Educational Foundation or to the office of the Grand Recorder of the Grand Encampment, 14 East Jackson Boulevard, Suite 1700, Chicago, Illinois 60604.

[Knights Templar Educational Foundation loans are subject to review triennially and allowable amounts may be changed. Check your Grand Recorder (Secretary/Treasurer) for current information.]

PATRIOTIC AND CIVIC ACTIVITIES

At the 49th Triennial Conclave of the Grand Encampment, the purpose of this Standing Committee was stated: "The committee shall foster and supervise activities of a patriotic and citizenship nature, whether in peacetime or in wartime, and shall present its recommendations for civic responsibility by Knights Templar individually and collectively, compatible with the patriotic principles of Templary."

This statement puts Templary squarely and firmly in support of those local activities which promote the civic welfare of every community as well as the national well-being of our country. It is the responsibility of this Committee to demonstrate good citizenship in every community as well as to promote our patriotic principles.

More than in other area of activity, the idea of Patriotic and Civic Activities is misunderstood. Some feel that of course we are patriotic and that no program is necessary to convince us of the truth of such an obvious fact. To them, we would say that it is not enough for Templary to be - rather, we must do! Other Templars, equally earnest, feel that Civic activity by Masons is forbidden. This is incorrect. A non-partisan support of our American institutions is no more to be criticized than our support of the Christian religion! Good Masons make good citizens - and good citizens are civically involved.

What Can We Do?

By programs for such a purpose, we can be citizens who are better informed as to the structures, operations, and needs of our civic institutions. We can emphasize the need for men of our sort - Christian Masons - in positions of civic responsibility, and we can honor those who heed the call and provide an audience for their expressions.

We can relate ourselves, whether by program or project, to high objectives and give honor to those who have made great personal sacrifices to give us our American heritage by activities related to Armed Forces Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day, and all national holidays.

Everyone must recognize that apathy and indifference have made deep inroads into American life. When we speak of "the good old days," we refer to the time when there was personal responsibility on the part of every citizen, and a concern to see that the forces of crime, corruption, violence, and disorder were conquered before they could gain even a foothold. We are appalled when we survey the present scene and contrast the days of law and order with what is rampant today. Countless thousands of people openly say they "couldn't care less" about what goes on in civic affairs. Murders, holdups and rapes are boldly perpetrated without too much fear of apprehension because people "don't want to become involved." Men and women turn away from the scene of a crime and do absolutely nothing to help the hapless victim or the police. They don't have sufficient interest to care about their fellow man in deepest distress! Instances of this are not limited to the big cities. Even small towns and rural communities are becoming infected with the same "disease" that is typified by the expression - "so what?"

The hour is late to combat this terrible moral scourge, but attack it we must, if we are to be true to our convictions. The cure lies deep in changing the moral fiber all over the country. America can't go on this way or we will degenerate as all previous civilizations have done. Every force for good in America must join a stout counterattack, and Templary with its militant spirit for righteousness must take an active part.

If ever there was a problem that can be started to be corrected on a local basis, and does not need to wait for Washington, this is one that will lend itself to self-help. Every Commandery in the country should have an active, alert, wide-awake Committee to cooperate in the civic and patriotic activity that is necessary to combat this insidious problem. Templary should generate the enthusiasm to do something real and tangible about it.

Every Commandery should have a committee, selected after careful consideration of the roster, of those best qualified to plan and execute both programs and projects, by experience, ability, and influence in community affairs. Let's look for the busy men who will be most effective and who might never have had time to serve as officers of the Commandery.

Our Christian character demands that we plan a project for the good of the community - something constructive and unselfish which will earn the respect and appreciation of both our members and the general public.

The Grand Encampment publishes "Guidelines on Patriotic and Civic Activities." It is available without charge upon request from the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

GUIDELINES for PATRIOTIC and CIVIC ACTIVITIES

" ... Promote the General Welfare and
Secure the Blessing of Liberty to ourselves
and our posterity... "



Committee on Patriotic and Civic Activities
Grand Encampment of Knights Templar
of the United States of America
Reissued 2002

PATRIOTIC AND CIVIC ACTIVITIES

At the 49th Triennial Conclave of the Grand Encampment at Philadelphia

1964, PATRIOTIC AND CIVIC ACTIVITIES

Section 106(c). The Committee on Patriotic and Civic Activities shall consist of a Chairman and six other members, to be appointed at each Triennial Conclave by the newly elected Grand Master, to serve until the close of the next Triennial Conclave.

“The committee shall foster and supervise activities of a patriotic and citizenship nature, whether in peacetime or in wartime, and shall present its recommendations for civic responsibility by Knights Templar individually and collectively, compatible with the patriotic principles of Templary.”

(1964, p. 370)(1967, p. 89)

Grand Encampment Committee on Patriotic and Civic Activities:

(1967-1970 Triennium)

Robert O. Wilson, Jr., P.G.C., Massachusetts and Rhode Island

Edward S. Piggins, P.G.C., Michigan

Ralph H. Slocum, P.D.C., California

Arthur J. Peterson, P.G.C., Minnesota

Albert W. Cross, P.G.C., Wyoming

Hal A. Burnett, P.G.C., Texas

John B. Cottrell, Jr., P.D.C., Pennsylvania, Chairman

THE PREMISE

The true image of Templary is exemplified by deeds, not only words. It is important that others - the general public - know what we are and what we stand for, but before we can transmit that awareness to them, we must be doing something, and that "something" must be an activity that demonstrates the purpose of Templary.

Our general concerns and interests as Knights Templar are in four significant areas:

1. Christianity,
2. Country,
3. Community, and
4. Commandery.

Encompassed under these headings are all the tenets of our Order and the Templar code of ethics.

The Grand Encampment Committee on Patriotic and Civic Activities has been charged with the assignment of providing Guidelines and suggestions for Templar programs and projects in the categories of Country and Community.

It is the Committee's conviction that the major accent, particularly at the Constituent Commandery level, belongs in the realm of Community Activities. The Community is the "Blue Lodge" of our Country - the first step, the parent body, so to speak. Before there could be a Republic there had to be Communities. There can be no better Templar program to show our love for Country and for our fellow citizens than participation, constructively and willingly, in Community Affairs.

This means no lessening of emphasis on the theme of Patriotism, as the term is understood. Every Templar, by conviction and training, is a loyal citizen. Individually and collectively, every Templar needs to communicate love and respect for his Country to his fellowmen - not by mere flag waving, but by education (programming), and by example in his daily life.

One of the Webster's definitions of a patriot is this:

"one who loves his country and zealously supports its authority and interests."

Let's carry that a step further in Templary and add another line to the definition:

"and one who strives to implant and strengthen those feelings of love and support in others."

On the following pages are suggestions and examples of Patriotic and Civic Activities and recommendations for Grand Commandery and Constituent Commandery organizations in these fields.

We are hopeful that they will provide a platform upon which each Commandery can build a strong and effective structure of programs and projects - especially in the history and development of our Country and in Community Involvement. As Templars, we have a splendid opportunity to plan and participate in programs designed to commemorate the third century of our nation.

The Grand Encampment of Knights Templar strongly urges support for the observance of patriotic holidays, but equally important is local involvement on the part of Constituent and Subordinate Commanderies. The Committee suggests PARTICIPATION IN COMMUNITY AFFAIRS OF EVERY HELPFUL AND PROGRESSIVE NATURE.

THE GRAND COMMANDERY

Patriotic and Civic Activity has long been recognized as an integral part of Templar responsibility but has suffered from a lack of direction. It needs to receive full and wholehearted programming in every Grand Commandery.

The functions of a Grand Commandery Committee for Patriotic and Civic Activities are:

1. To have a Patriotic and Civic Activities Committee formed in every Commandery in the jurisdiction. -
2. To insist the Committee be representative of the membership rather than from a list of officers or past officers. It may be the means of reactivating a member whose interest in Templary is waning or was never motivated.
3. To encourage and assist each Commandery to plan and execute at least one appropriate project during the Templar year.
4. To enlist a panel of informed and able speakers on patriotic and historic subjects in every section of your state who will be available to speak at Commandery Conclaves and at Commandery-sponsored meetings where non-Templars might be invited to attend.
5. To plan and supervise statewide patriotic observance at historical sites and patriotic shrines within the state.
6. To evaluate and follow the progress of the Committee in each Commandery and to re-encourage and re-activate those Commanderies not reporting activity.
7. To inform the Grand Encampment Committee of the progress of the overall program and to report any outstandingly effective and productive program or activity.

THE CONSTITUENT COMMANDERY

The Grand Encampment Committee has made a survey study of programs and activities and offers the following as suggestions; some are appropriate for a single meeting, some as a continuing project and some for both. These are suggestions and not more than one or two should be planned by most Commanderies. Each Commandery Committee must be governed by local conditions and opportunities as well as by the number of Sir Knights and the financial capabilities of the Commandery. No Commandery should feel bound to use these specific suggestions. All Commanderies are encouraged to use their local initiative in planning Patriotic and Civic Activities.

1. Assist your Commander in planning a patriotic program for a Conclave near a national holiday.
2. lead a discussion on the Asylum floor discussing how your Commandery can express itself in the Community by service.
3. Plan a program stressing law and order either for a Conclave or, preferably, for a Commandery-sponsored public meeting.
4. Sponsor or join in sponsoring a Naturalization Court. Sponsor a recognition dinner for new citizens with judges and other public officials in attendance.
5. Encourage members to register and vote in every public election. Sponsor or join in sponsoring a public campaign to register and vote.
6. Develop a dinner with a patriotic theme, patriotic speaker, patriotic decorations, and patriotic music.
7. Join with other organizations in patriotic parades and public patriotic displays.
8. Encourage members to assist all youth organizations: DeMolay, Rainbow, Job's Daughters, Boy Scouts, Girl Scouts, and others.
9. Sponsor junior citizenship awards and patriotic competitions in your Community.
10. Sponsor school essay contests on patriotism.
11. Provide speakers to carry the message of the Knights Templar Eye Foundation and the Knights Templar Educational Foundation to service clubs, youth organizations, parent associations, medical societies, and similar groups.
12. If possible, arrange a presentation at a local school assembly on historic themes: The American Flag, Declaration of Independence, etc., or plan a program around an individual - a local patriot and/or Mason - whose name is recognized in the community.
13. Seek a community need and go to work to alleviate it. Provide hospital bed loans, wheelchair loans, crutch and walker loans, and respirator loans.
14. Bring Commandery activity and cooperation to Community causes - blood bank, United Campaign, Christmas Seal drive, and others.
15. Organize assistance to police and juvenile courts.
16. Plan picnics, parties, programs and outings for local orphans and underprivileged children and senior citizens.
17. Charge every Sir Knight with his responsibility:
 - a. To set an example to his children and others by obeying the laws himself.
 - b. To vote his convictions at every public election.
 - c. To accept the Bill of Responsibility as well as the Bill of Rights.
 - d. To become part of the vocal majority as well as a part of the statistical majority.

- e. To learn about his police department, his school board, and his local courts of law.
- f. To know his children's friends and associates.
- g. To cooperate and assist in his Commandery's Patriotic and Civic Activity Program.

KNIGHTS TEMPLAR AND THE US. FLAG

Historically, Knight Templary is the most visible branch of Freemasonry, participating in uniform in parades and patriotic observances. Swords, plumes, and flags flashing in the breeze, we represent the entire Masonic fraternity to the profane world.

When a Knight Templar fails to show the proper respect for the Flag of the United States, it brings discredit upon the Order, as well as the Flag. A few simple rules or flag etiquette, if observed by ALL Sir Knights, will serve as an example for everyone. As militant Christian Masons, we must be ever vigilant in showing the way "by precept and example."

HOW TO DISPLAY THE FLAG

Laws have been written to govern the use of the flag and to ensure a proper respect for the Stars and Stripes. Customs has decreed certain other observances in regard to its use. Rules on flag display having direct bearing on Asylum usage are given below. What follows, however, is not intended as a complete list of rules.

The National flag should be raised and lowered by hand. Do not raise the flag while it is furled. Unfurl, then hoist quickly to the top of the staff. Lower it slowly and with dignity. Place no objects on or over the flag. A speaker's table should never be covered with the flag.

When displayed in the Asylum (or on a platform in a church) the flag should be placed on a staff at the Commander's (or clergyman's) right; other flags at his left.

When displayed over the middle of the street, the flag should be suspended vertically with the union to the north in an east-west street. or to the east in a north-south street.

When displayed with another flag from crossed staffs, the flag of the United States of America should be on the right (the flag's own right) and its staff should be in front of the staff of the other flag.

When flags of states or cities or pennants of societies are flown on the same halyard with the flag of the United States of America, the latter should always be at the peak.

When flown from adjacent staffs the Stars and Stripes should be hoisted first and lowered last.

When the flag is suspended over a sidewalk from a rope extending from the house to the pole at the edge of the sidewalk, the flag should be hoisted out from the building, toward the pole, union first.

When the flag is displayed in a manner other than by being flown from a staff, it should be displayed flat, whether indoors or out. When displayed either horizontally or vertically against a wall, the union should be uppermost and to the flag's own right, that is, to the observer's left. When displayed in a window it should be displayed in the same way, that is, with the union or blue field to the left of the observer in the street.

When festoons, rosettes or drapings are desired, bunting of blue, white, and red should be used, but never the flag.

When a number of flags of states or cities or pennants of societies are grouped and displayed from staffs with our National flag, the latter should be at the center or at the highest point of the group.

Do not use the flag as a portion of a costume or athletic uniform. Do not embroider it upon cushions or handkerchiefs nor print it on paper napkins or boxes.

When the flag is used in unveiling a statue or monument, it should not serve as a covering of the object to be unveiled. If it is displayed on such occasions, do not allow the flag to fall to the ground, but let it be carried aloft to form a feature of the ceremony.

Take every precaution to prevent the flag from becoming soiled. It should not be allowed to touch the ground or floor, nor to brush against objects.

When carried the flag should always be aloft and free - never flat or horizontal. We can do a big service for the Masonic-oriented youth groups by advising them of this, as well as other methods of displaying the flag.

Never use the flag as drapery of any sort whatsoever. Bunting of blue, white, and red - arranged with the blue above, the white in the middle, and the red below - should be used for such purposes of decoration as covering a speaker's desk or draping the front of a platform.

No other flag may be flown above the Stars and Stripes, except:

- (1) the United Nations flag at U.N. Headquarters;
- (2) the church pennant, a dark blue cross on a white background, during church services conducted by naval chaplains at sea.

More - than fifty years ago it was the custom to salute the National flag by uncovering; nowadays the hand salute is rendered by the entire personnel of the Armed Forces and all Knights Templar in uniform.

During the ceremony of hoisting or lowering the flag, or when the flag is passing in a parade or in a review, those present in uniform should render the right-hand salute.

When not in uniform, men should remove their headdress with the right hand and hold it at the left shoulder, the hand being over the heart; men, not covered, and women should place the right hand over the heart.

It is the universal custom to display the national flag from sunrise to sunset on buildings and on stationary flagstaffs in the open on all days that weather permits, but especially on national holidays and other days that may be proclaimed by the President of the United States. The U.S. flag may be displayed 24 hours a day, if properly illuminated during hours of darkness.

The flag can be displayed on all days when the weather permits, especially on:

- New Year's Day, January 1;
- Inauguration Day, January 20;
- Lincoln's Birthday, February 12;
- Washington's Birthday, February 22;
- Easter Sunday (variable);
- Mother's Day, the second Sunday in May;
- Armed Forces Day, the third Saturday in May;
- Memorial Day (half-staff until noon), May 30;
- Flag Day, June 14;
- Independence Day, July 4;
- Labor Day, the first Monday in September;
- Constitution and Citizenship Day, September 17;
- Columbus Day, October 12;
- Veterans Day, November 11;
- Thanksgiving Day, the fourth Thursday in November;
- Christmas Day, December 25;
- such other days as may be proclaimed by the President of the United States;
- the birthdays of States (dates of admission); and on
- State holidays.

When the flag is in such a condition, through wear or damage, that it is no longer a fitting emblem for display, it should be destroyed in a dignified way, preferably by burning.

RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES

The characteristic purpose and the motivating dynamic of a Knight Templar, and of this Order, is a vigorous support of the Christian religion. Not only is an expressive program in this area central to the whole program of Templary, but, together with the essentials of leadership and growth, all other programs relate to it. The Grand Encampment has a Committee on Religious Activities and it has a well-rounded program of activities that will lead us throughout the entire Triennium. The appointment of state and local committees having a broad assignment similar to that of the national committee is urgently requested. Among other recommendations of the Committee on Religious Activities are the following:

1. To promote by every means, for the individual Templar, an earnest devotion to the program and work of his own church. The Order of Knights Templar is properly no substitute for church activity and interest. We claim only a companion loyalty, in that Templary is the very handmaiden of the Church.
2. To bring a religious emphasis to every Conclave. It has been suggested that each month the Prelate or a member of the Committee or a member selected might, by scripture reading and a brief but dynamic presentation, emphasize the meaning of a major Sunday of the month.
3. Public appearances, primarily by church attendance in full Templar uniform in a body on special occasions, also in Templar and Masonic parades, funerals, festivals, etc. Two essentials are common to all: that we identify ourselves to bear Christian witness. All public appearances should be carefully planned and executed, and we should appear in the largest numbers possible.
4. Christian burial. It is our basic duty to assist in the Christian burial of our fallen Templars when requested, or to conduct some memorial service otherwise, which might be at the funeral parlors, or in the Asylum at the next stated Conclave as a minimum memorial. To see that a uniformed unit is formed and always available for such occasions is the business of the committee, as well as working out and providing very prompt notice of such plans to all members.
5. Close relations should be maintained with local ministers. Thus, any joint enterprise of theirs can be supported, they may be honored by us on suitable occasions and we will be better able to avoid any conflict with their programs.
6. Work with other committees in related programs, such as support of Christian Youth groups, DeMolay and other Youth groups for character building, observance of Public School Week and participate in the fight against Godless Communism. Our emphasis upon our Christian character must be carried with us into all of these activities.

A Grand Encampment "Guidelines on Religious Activities" is available without charge upon request from the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

Suggested scripts for Templar observances of Christmas, Easter and Ascension Day are included in the "Manual of Public Ceremonies," also available through the Grand Recorder's office at \$.50 each.

EASTER SUNRISE SERVICES

Easter is a hallowed day in the Temp Jar calendar. Marking as it does the resurrection of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, Easter represents the summit of all the hopes of our Christian Faith. The Grand Encampment especially encourages every Sir Knight to attend the church of his choice on that great day and join with other millions of professing Christians in celebrating the great victory of Christ over death.

In some places throughout the country, Constituent Commanderies sponsor their own Easter Sunrise Services and invite the general public to attend. In some instances these have become giant Easter Services attracting thousands. Many Knights Templar appear in full Templar uniform and present a public image of loyalty and devotion to the Christian principles which we espouse. Each year still more Commanderies sponsor their own Easter services or attend church as a uniformed body to proclaim our fealty to Christ. The Grand Encampment heartily commends Easter celebrations and urges all local Commanderies to consider adopting the Easter Service as an integral part of their annual program.

The official Easter Sunrise Memorial Service, held each year at sacred Arlington National Cemetery, is sponsored by The Armed Services Chaplains Committee and The Military District of Washington in cooperation with the Knights

Templar of the United States of America who are responsible for organizing this civic memorial event. At promptly 7:00 a.m., Sir Knights from all over the country form a line at the West Gate and march behind the strains of "Onward Christian Soldiers" to take their places in the center of the Amphitheatre. The program is broadcast starting at 7:30 a.m. and includes a sermon by the Right Eminent Grand Prelate or some other distinguished clergyman, and a message from the Grand Master. A giant cross of lilies is then carried through the lines under an arch of steel and deposited at the Tomb of the Unknown Soldier. To this service, Knights Templar are urged to come and join the marching hosts. In every nearby Grand Commandery jurisdiction there should be a special Committee in charge of arrangements to start early in the year to get up a maximum attendance to march behind their own Grand Commandery Standard on this auspicious occasion. Thousands attend this public ceremony each year!

GUIDELINES for RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES

*"Faith without works
is dead! "*



*"Be not weary in
well-doing. "*

Committee on Religious Activities
Grand Encampment of Knights Templar
of the United States of America
January 1995

INTRODUCTION

Today one cannot read, hear, or see any news medium without encountering the word "militant". We are all familiar with the activities characteristics of some of those who seek, by almost any means revolutionary changes in the political, economic and. social life of ow nation. Even our established religious institutions are under pressure from within by groups of such "militant" nature.

But long before this contemporary phenomenon Templary itself was a militant organization. It remains militant, and must continue to be so if it is to be true to its historic heritage. Otherwise, there is nothing more than an archaic quaintness to the declaration of its own members, each of whom has vowed to "wield my sword" in defense of certain individuals as well as in defense of one specific institution - the Church of Jesus Christ!

There is a difference in being militant for destruction and a militancy dedicated to preservation. The Knight Templar is militant in defense of the Church as the body of which "the Great Captain of our Salvation," our Lord Jesus Christ, is the head.

Thus Templary and the Church are inseparable, the former supporting, supplementing, implementing the latter, never being a substitute for or in competition with the one institution which gives Templary its meaning_ and reason for existence. Templary can no more separate itself from the defense of the Church and yet remain Templary; than the individual Knight Templar can abandon his Christian faith and yet remain a member of our Valiant and Magnanimous. Order!

But faith is not mere belief! *Faith is action*; acting on the basis of what one believes. Thus, the Biblical warning that "faith without works is dead."

It is hoped that this brochure may be helpful in suggestions it makes for Commanderies of Knights Templar to act out the faith they profess. The ideas herein may well engender others, wherever there is imagination and creativity.

But let one question continue to gnaw at every body of Templary – how Christian, and how militant can it be; unless there is within every Grand Commandery, and in every Constituent and Subordinate Commandery as well, a Committee on Religious Activities?

SOME BASIC "DO's" AND "DON'T's"

1. **DO** give thought, imagination, time, and ingenuity to planning, and executing new, creative religious activities in the Commandery. **DON'T** neglect Templary's traditional observances at Christmastide, Eastertide, and Ascensiontide, but remember always that "new occasions teach new duties."
2. This is "*the ecumenical age*." When inviting clergymen to attend social affairs or other open activities of Commanderies, **DO** show an awareness of the ecumenical progress of our generation by avoiding any denomination emphasis,
3. **DO** publicize religious activities before and after they occur. Follow the suggestions in the Grand Encampment Guidelines for Publicity and Public Relations.
4. **DO** consult the clergy of your locality as to what the Commandery may do to assist them and their Churches. **DON'T** try to "use" the clergy to promote the Commandery.
5. When a frater has departed this life, unless the family has requested otherwise and the clergyman agrees, **DO** have separate services. Remember Templary provides for two services: a memorial service and a burial service. Because many clergymen are hypersensitive, in such matters, even those who are Masons and Knights Templar, **DO** try to have the Templar Memorial Service the evening prior to the religious rites of the Church, preferably at the funeral home.
6. If both Templar and ecclesiastical services are to be held, with one following the other immediately, **DO** let the Church service be last. This is especially important if the Templar service is the one to be used at the grave. At the very least, have the clergyman give the final benediction.
7. If there is a choice, let the Commandery give the Templar Memorial Service at the funeral home the night before the funeral, and let the committal at the grave be handled by the representative of the church.
- 2.1 In a formal, structured Church Service where Templars and their families are invited guests, if there are to be any introductions **DO** give the presiding clergyman well in advance the correct names and proper titles of Templary personnel. **DON'T** assume the clergyman knows all about Templary – DO put brief, clear information in writing in his hands well before such occasions.

SUGGESTIONS FOR RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES COMMITTEES IN GRAND COMMANDERIES

1. Every Grand Commandery should have a Committee on Religious Activities which is not at all the same as a Committee on Necrology, etc. This Committee, in consultation with the minister of the host Church, should plan well in advance the Church Service at every Grand Commandery Conclave. If the Eminent Grand Prelate is not a member of the Committee (as he should be), consult him as an advisor.
2. The Grand Commandery Committee on Religious Activities should pay careful attention to every issue of the *Knight Templar Magazine* selecting from each issue examples of religious activities successfully promulgated through Templary, and at least quarterly call these to the attention of Commanderies within its jurisdiction.
3. The Grand Commandery Committee on Religious Activities should receive monthly, or at least quarterly, reports of activities of a religious nature which have been sponsored by or have taken place in the Constituent Commanderies. The Grand Commandery Committee should not assume that the local Commandery has reported these to the editor of the Knight Templar Magazine but should itself report them. It is better for the national news organization to have duplicate reports than none at all.
4. To further York Rite Unity, the Grand Commandery Committee on Religious Activities should attempt cooperative endeavors with comparable groups in other York Rite bodies, on the state or district level. There are some occasions, such as St. John's Day, when Commanderies and Symbolic Lodges can together sponsor and participate in meaningful religious activities. Another example would be on Reformation Sunday, the last Sunday in October, when Commanderies and Royal Arch Chapters can combine for a relevant observance.
5. The Grand Commandery Committee should arrange for and execute a fitting Memorial Service for departed fraters at every Grand Commandery Conclave. But let it be positive in tone, celebrating life's final accomplishment – the achievement of immortality. Use a choir from a local church, if possible, to provide music which is a ringing affirmation of our belief in eternal life.
6. The Grand Commandery Committee, or the Grand Prelate, should send a card of sympathy to the surviving family of a deceased frater, the Recorder or Prelate of the Constituent Commandery sending AT ONCE the proper information such as name of the frater, name and address of the next of kin, etc. (Appropriate cards may be procured at a nominal cost from Church supply houses, but better to print one's own.)

SUGGESTIONS FOR RELIGIOUS ACTIVITIES COMMITTEES IN CONSTITUENT COMMANDERIES

1. If local conditions make it difficult or impossible to meet on Christmas day for the traditional observance in the Asylum, schedule such a service as close as possible to Christmas Day, but such a service may appropriately be held at any time during the Christian season of Advent. Invite clergy.
2. Consider, as a variation, the scheduling of a suitable activity for Epiphany, or "Twelfth Night." This commemorates the arrival of the Wise Men, and is an excellent opportunity for special programming, perhaps, in cooperation with other Masonic bodies.
3. In January each year there is an Octave (or Week) of Prayers for Christian Unity sponsored by interdenominational agencies. Contact your local or area Ministerial Association or Council of Churches and ascertain if one or more of these services can be sponsored by the Commandery, perhaps, even held in the Asylum. The Commandery could well precede the service with a dinner, to which local clergy and their wives could be invited.
4. Contact your local Ministerial Association or Council of Churches and determine if the Commandery can participate in some significant way in one or more of a series of special Lenten services. Perhaps, one of these could be held in the Asylum. Again, here is an opportunity to invite local clergy and their wives.
5. Encourage attendance at the Grand Encampment Easter Sunrise Service at Arlington, Virginia, by publicity well in advance. For those unable to go, consider one of two things:
 - (A) Hold the traditional Easter Service in the Asylum followed by breakfast;
 - (B) approach well in advance of the date your local Ministerial Association or Council of Churches and determine if the Commandery can participate in a Union Sunrise Service in some significant way. If (B) is chosen, the traditional Templar Easter Service in the Asylum could be scheduled at another time during Eastertide - perhaps, at the Vesper Hour on Easter Sunday late afternoon.
6. Sponsor an Ascension Day Service under Commandery auspices, inviting local clergymen to participate. The service may be held in the Asylum, in a local Church, in a local park, etc.
7. Remembering that the Christian Church was born at Pentecost, sponsor a Pentecost service in the Asylum, inviting the community and asking local clergy to participate. Or, as a variant, conduct such a service in local or area institutions such as nursing homes, orphanages, jails, etc.

8. Contact local or area patriotic organizations and arrange for Commandery participation in Memorial Day Services late in May. Conduct such a service at a Veterans Hospital, if there is one in your community.
9. Using the theme, "One Nation Under God" or "In God We Trust," sponsor or participate in an outdoor religious service in conjunction with the observance of Independence Day. Encourage participation by local clergy or area churches.
10. Most communities have union services for the observance of Thanksgiving. Ascertain through your local Ministerial Association of Council of Churches what opportunity there can be for Commandery participation. Such public exposure always helps the image of Templary.
11. Conduct a campaign in the community and especially among the membership to participate in charitable activities following the admonition of the Lord to feed the hungry and cloth the naked.
12. Consider sponsoring Sunday afternoon Vesper Services in the following:
 - A. Hospital chapels.
 - B. Convalescent Homes.
 - C. Veterans Hospitals
 - D. Jails.
 - E. Homes for Unwed Mothers and similar institutions.
13. Conduct annually an impressive Memorial Service for departed fraters of your Commandery. Consider joining with other local Masonic groups for a combined Memorial Service. Rotate the address, if any, among the clergy of the community, or the music among the church choirs in the community.
14. If it is not in competition with a local Church's Maundy Thursday celebration, consider holding a service of The Feast of the Paschal Lamb, especially if there is no Scottish Rite observance in the area.
15. Consider having the Commandery participate in some meaningful way in a community's Union Good Friday Tre Ore (Three Hour) Service. For a variation, perhaps such a service could be held in the Asylum. Invite local clergy to conduct the various portions of the service, if it is held in the Asylum. If in a local church, ask for ways the Commandery can assist.
16. If a Union Good Friday Service is scheduled in a community at the traditional hours from noon until three o'clock, the Commandery can take the lead in asking merchants to close for those three hours.

17. Sponsor a luncheon or dinner once each year for the local or area clergy and their wives and children. Present a program which does not involve the ministers in having to speak. They will be glad to be relieved!
18. Supply for all Masonic bodies place mats or napkins with a variety of 'table graces' imprinted thereon.
19. Celebrate the Commandery's birthday each year, or especially significant anniversaries of the Commandery, by asking each frater to bring his clergyman with him as a special or honored guest.
20. Attend each year in a body the church of the Eminent Commander as an expression of the fraternal regard for him.
21. Constantly encourage at every Conclave of the Commandery the necessity of every able-bodied frater's being in his proper place at his own Church every Sunday morning.
22. At meetings when no Degree work is involved a Meditation can be given on some aspect of the Birth, life, Death, Resurrection, and Ascension of our Lord. The Prelate can be in charge, but many laymen are quite capable of presenting such meditations since they have insights unique and different from those of the ordained clergy. The Book of Acts and the New Testament Epistles can be used productively in addition to the Gospel.
23. Sponsor a forum or panel discussion of local or area clergymen on some such topic as "The Mission of The Church Today.
24. Consider providing Hymnals or other needed items for new or impoverished Churches in the community. A bookplate showing the presentation by the Commandery can be placed in each Hymnal.
25. Just as the Christian may be "the only Bible someone will ever read," so the Commandery at its Conclaves should frequently remind each frater that the individual Knight Templar, not only when he is seen in public as such, but in the organization to which he belongs and at all other times, he is "the walking billboard of Templary". His ethics should be unimpeachable; his conduct always exemplary.
26. Once annually schedule an "Early Morning Praise Service and Breakfast," perhaps on a Saturday or Sunday morning. (Annual Praise Services have been conducted for several decades by Dieu le Veut Commandery No. 45, Wilkes-Barre, Pennsylvania.)
27. When any frater is elected to a Church office of importance, or is chosen to head a Church project in the community, hold a special "Appreciation Night" in his honor, inviting his own clergyman to participate.

28. Consider making available to the community appropriate Easter cards of greeting, perhaps, giving samples to the local clergy with the suggestion that if they think them worthy they may announce their availability in local church publications.
29. Through releases to area newspapers, radio stations., etc. sponsor a "Keep Christ in Christmas" emphasis.
30. Ascertain what can be done to support the needs of young people's groups in local Churches, or such movements as Youth for Christ, etc.
31. Give to each newly created Knight Templar a New Testament.
32. Ascertain from local clergy or the Council of Churches the possibility of the Commandery's sponsoring a joint observance of World Wide Communion Sunday (the first Sunday in October), the service to be conducted by ordained clergy, and perhaps, using the liturgy of The Church of South India.
33. On Universal Bible Sunday (the second Sunday in December), the Commandery can sponsor an observance and collect contributions to the work of The American Bible Society.
34. Follow your own ideas! Be creative! "Write your own ticket!" This list is intended to be merely suggestive, not comprehensive or exclusive. But DO SOMETHING!
35. Suggested Scripts for Religious Services, another Grand Encampment Guideline, contains suggested services for Christmas, Easter and Ascension. It is available from the office of the Grand Recorder.

YOUTH ACTIVITIES

Templary is tremendously interested in the Youth of America and is manifesting its interest in a multitude of ways throughout the country. In some Commanderies, work is being done in the field of far-reaching efforts to prevent juvenile delinquency and to rescue young boys and girls in their teens from lives of crime. Some Commanderies are employing a full-time Chaplain in work 21 through the Courts and in detention homes. In some Commanderies, work is being done in connection with Boy Scouts, YMCA and similar groups by emphasizing the positive - acting as Scout Master or Big Brother to encourage the leading of useful lives by Youth. In some Commanderies, a Chapter of the Order of DeMolay has been sponsored and Sir Knights are actively helping in many ways to counsel, support, and assist DeMolay to grow and prosper. Whatever method is adopted, it is apparent that Commanderies are beginning more and more to realize their unique Christian opportunity to help Youth in these desperate times when moral standards have been lowered and Youth has become the target for all sorts of temptations. All of these efforts should be encouraged by our organization because Youth needs the example of mature Knights Templar to witness for Christ and our great Christian cause.

In this connection, the Grand Encampment is especially interested in the work of the Order of Knighthood of the Order of DeMolay. Here is an organization that is teaching the great moral precepts of life and character to thousands of boys who are walking the paths of right living but need the extra encouragement of men who understand them and their problems. Templars should take a keener and more personal interest in this magnificent group of boys who might some day be knocking at the doors of Masonry. The greatest need of DeMolay is for counsellors and advisors who will encourage them by actual attendance at their meetings and ceremonies. The Grand Encampment has taken concrete steps to bring Templary in closer contact with DeMolay. Every Grand Commandery should have a Committee on Youth Activities and should encourage and activate Templary activities in connection with Youth.

A PILGRIMAGE TO THE HOLY LAND

Section 113¼ (a) of the Grand Encampment Constitution and Statutes provides for the development of a Grand Encampment Committee, as follows:

There shall be a Committee on Holy Land Pilgrimages. It shall have the general oversight of the practical working of sending ordained Christian Ministers, gratis, on Pilgrimages to the Holy Land, for their spiritual enrichment, enthusiasm, and refreshed dedication.

The election of participation by the various respective Grand Commanderies and Subordinate Commanderies in Holy Land Pilgrimages, shall be optional with them.

It shall, from time to time, transmit to the Grand Encampment matters of interest and recommendations for the pm per administration of its purpose.

It is suggested that this optional program should be undertaken only with the full support and agreement of the individual Grand Commandery.

KNIGHTS TEMPLAR EDUCATIONAL FOUNDATION NOTE: Loans are subject to review triennially and allowable amounts may be changed. Check your Grand Recorder (Secretary/Treasurer) for current information.

TEMPLARY ON THE MOVE

MEMBERSHIP

The trumpet call for any Triennium should be:

EVERY CHRISTIAN MASON SHOULD BE A KNIGHT TEMPLAR!

- A. In Templary a Christian finds Masonry expressed in terms he can best understand. In Templary he finds not only moral instructions, fellowship, and fraternity, but a militancy and a dedication to the advancement of Christ's Kingdom. He finds an evangelical climate which his Christian commitment has taught him to understand. He finds a loyal band of Christian warriors with whom he has much in common. He can give service to the broad objectives of Christianity by combining his efforts with others of kindred minds and hearts.
 - B. As the Christian Mason needs Templary, so does the Commandery need him. Templary must have the strength that comes through increased manpower. As a blood transfusion injects new life into the body, just so does the "new blood" of Templar recruits furnish new life to the Commandery. Their impact quickens the whole structure of the Commandery.
 - C. In order to recruit Christian Masons to enlist under our banner, we ourselves must be completely "sold." Only then can we generate enthusiasm for our Cause. We must know "our product" in order to "sell" others. The art of "selling Templary" is based on the same kind of persuasion that governs everything else in the world. We must convince the Christian Mason that we have something he needs. It ought not to be hard to persuade a Christian Mason that he belongs with us. Let's be able to tell him Templary stands for the highest ideals of Christianity. It represents the noblest in humanity. It reveals Christianity in action!
- Let us answer any questions by telling him the story of our allegiance to protect and defend the Christian faith. Let us explain to him our commitment to commemorate the birth, life, death, resurrection, and ascension of the Great Captain of our Salvation. Let us tell him of our witness in everyday life for the upright and moral things in the community in which we live.
- Let us tell him about our symbolic ancestors - the brave Crusaders of the Middle Ages when Knighthood was in flower - as well as our modern peaceful devotion to the same noble principles for which they fought. Let us tell him of our public parades where we proudly march as a Mighty Host in step with the stirring battle song of "Onward Christian Soldiers." Let us tell him of our religious activities at Easter, Ascension Day, and Christmas, and our staunch support of civic decency.
- Let us assure each Christian Mason how much his enlistment under the banner of Templary will mean in stimulating the good impulses and the forces of righteousness in which he, himself, believes. Let us tell him how much he needs us! Let us convince him by our enthusiasm for our Cause and the sincerity of our appeal that we are in dead earnest when we tell him we want him to come with us - now! Only with such high purpose and zeal will we be worthy to start out on the job of recruiting Christian manpower for Templar Masonry.

No Mason can fully appreciate the depth of the work of Masonry until he has participated in the work of the Orders of Knighthood! No seeker after truth will ever be able to experience anything more impressive and inspiring than the Order of the Temple.

- D. Every Grand Commandery and every Constituent and Subordinate Commandery should have an active Membership Committee.

The invitation to Christian Masons should come from Templars. We should not be smug or stand idly by and assume that Christian Masons will storm at our doors to join, simply because our cause is noble - even though we have something they need. We ourselves should be the ones to initiate the selective process by extending an individual invitation to each Christian Mason. If he becomes sufficiently interested, he will find a way to accomplish it.

In these modern days, men are so constituted that they need to be continually "sold" on the most essential things in life - and Templary is no exception. We need to consult new ways to win men to our banner. We need not become undignified, but we need to adopt an "approach" and a "way" that will get successful results.

- E. Our goals require action by every Eminent Commander. The Commander should confer with his dais officers and Recorders and other Sir Knights to select the man best qualified by ability and dedication to serve as Chairman of the Membership Committee. He should get a man with executive ability, determination, prestige and popularity in the community as well as in the Commandery. He should select a Chairman without regard to Templar rank or past attendance record, but one who will work and take the job seriously for one full year. Following the appointment of the committee, several planning sessions should be held - the Chairman and Committee members working with the Commander - until the entire membership plan for the Commandery is clearly formed, thoroughly digested, and definitely understood by everyone connected with the plan.

- F. The Membership Committee should:

- a. Adopt a Goal The goal of the Membership Committee should be positive in terms of how many membership petitions are being sought.
- b. Building an Organization. As many members as possible should be involved - the Committee furnishing the planning, the directions, and the evaluation of the total program. They should select, direct, and remain in close contact with each of the Blue Lodges, Chapters, Councils, Shrine Temples, Scottish Rite Valleys, the churches, service clubs, professional groups, and each large store, business, and industry. Also, the Committee should build and keep a record of all prospects and of contacts made with them, these cards carrying all useful information.
- c. Plan the Approach to Prospective Members. The approach to a prospective member should never be casual. He should be informed about the Commandery and its program, and told why he should become a member - why he needs the Commandery and why the Commandery needs him. Usually, an advance appointment

should be made. If possible, a known and respected friend who is a Knight Templar should be involved.

- d. Follow-Up. A record should be kept of every individual contact with a prospective member. His reaction should be recorded and future contacts planned.
- e. Selection of Contacts. There is room in Templary for every Christian Mason. Our ministers, professional, business, and civic leaders, and all young Masons should be on this list.
- f. Review the Progress. After each cycle of effort, usually in connection with each planned ritualistic program, the Membership Committee will study and revise its list of prime prospects.

The Grand Encampment publishes "Guidelines on Membership," available without charge upon request from the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

GUIDELINES FOR MEMBERSHIP "HOW TO DEVELOP AN EFFECTNE MEMBERSHIP PROGRAM."

Membership
the Lifeblood...



Committee on Membership
Grand Encampment of Knights Templar
of the United States of America
Revised-June 1992

I: PREFACE

In 1970, the Committee on Membership of the Grand Encampment was appointed by the 1967-70 Grand Master, Sir Knight John L. Crofts, Sr., to prepare, in cooperation with the Grand Recorder, Membership Guidelines for suggested use by Grand, Subordinate, and Constituent Commanderies. The Committee was composed of Robert E. Billings, P.G.C., Wisconsin; Henry J. Weisser, P.G.C., California; and, as Chairman, Gordon J. Brenner, P.G.C., New Jersey.

In 1979, Edward T. Bloomquist, P.G.C., Texas, was appointed Chairman of the Grand Encampment Committee on Membership by the incoming Grand Master, Kenneth C. Johnson. Sir Knight Bloomquist and his Committee - J.B. McQuirt, P.G.C., South Carolina, and T. Olin Gore, Jr., P.G.C., Mississippi - then proceeded to study the problem at hand. What developed was a series of letters directed toward attracting new members and retaining those already on the Commandery roles. These letters are appended to this brochure for possible use by any Grand Commandery.

II: OBTAINING NEW MEMBERS

A. Inspirational

To enlist Christian Masons, we, ourselves, must be completely "sold." ' And we must know "our product" in order to "sell others." We must convince the Christian Mason that we have something he needs and deserves. Let's learn to express our own conviction. to let him know that Templary stands for the highest ideals of Christianity. It represents the noblest in humanity. It reveals Christianity in action!

In Templary a Christian finds Masonry expressed in terms he can best understand, and appreciate. He finds a Christian climate to match his Christian commitment. He finds a loyal band of Christian warriors with whom he has much in common. He can give service to the broad objectives of Christianity by combining his practical efforts with others of kindred minds and hearts.

Some men are so constituted that they need to be "sold" on the most essential qualities of life - and Templary is no exception. We need constantly to consult old and consider new ways to win men to our Christian Masonic fraternity.

Assure each Christian Mason that his enlistment in Templary will stimulate the good impulses and the forces of right in which he believes. Show him by our daily actions that we support the upright and moral causes in the community in which we live. By high purpose and demonstrated zeal we will be prepared to sally forth to recruit Christian manpower for Templary.

A Templar knows that no Mason can fully appreciate the depth of the work of Masonry until he has participated in the Order of Knighthood! Present members imbued with this conviction need to impart it to prospective members.

Leadership in Commanderies calls for men of the finest caliber - men who, are not only inspired, out who are also diligent, active, and talented.

Let us assure our Commandries by our concerted membership efforts that we will always have men of leadership qualification to assume Leadership posts.

B. Organizational

To present its membership program successfully and secure new members each Grand Commandery should have a Grand Commandery Membership Committee, several Zone Membership Chairmen, and Individual Constituent Commandery Membership Committees. Suggested duties and functions of these Committees are:

1. Grand Commandery Membership Chairman
 - a. Recruit and train Zone Membership Chairmen.
 - b. Arrange Grand Commandery membership meetings. These meetings of various Zone Membership Chairmen must provide the initial dynamics for the entire program. General policy should be discussed and problems in the different Zones analyzed and solutions formulated. All successful methods and ideas should be considered, adopted, and developed.
 - c. Arrange State Festivals.

- d. Help to encourage state patriotic and civic activities, religious activities and all prescribed Committee projects, including the Knights Templar Educational Foundation and Eye Foundation.
 - e. Receive all Zone membership reports, analyze, condense and present written summaries to the Grand Commander and Grand Recorder. A periodic progress report should also be sent to the Grand Encampment Membership Chairman.
2. Zone Membership Chairman
- a. Train and assist Membership Chairmen of the constituent Commanderies.
 - b. Hold Zone membership meetings. These meetings should develop fellowship, competition among the Commanderies, and discussions on procedures and successful aids. The Zone Membership Chairman should be prepared to answer any questions which the Membership Chairmen ask.
 - c. Arrange Zone Festivals.
 - d. Promote and assist in all accepted projects which contribute to a favorable image of Templary in the area. Promoting and aiding these activities on a Zone basis can be more effective than on a Constituent Commandery basis.
 - e. Report to and cooperate with the Grand Commandery Membership Chairman.
3. Constituent Commandery Membership Committee
- a. Recruit Membership committeemen. Chairman to recruit at least one committee member for each Blue Lodge and/or Royal Arch Chapter within the Commandery area.
 - b. Plan Membership Meetings. Chairman to keep committeemen posted on zone festivals, state festivals, zone activities, and local situations. Committeemen are to report on activities in their territories and what progress is being made to obtain new members. Assistance needed from Zone or Grand Commandery committees should be reported.
 - c. Formulate Membership Program. Committeemen to gather trestleboards for all Lodges and Chapters in their territories. Committeemen to attend Lodge meetings on degree nights and meet the candidates. The same procedure should be followed for the Chapter meetings (and Council meetings where the Council is a prerequisite). Committeemen to supply each resident member of the Constituent Commandery with a petition and convince the member to secure one new member or to reactivate a demitted or suspended member.
 - d. Report to Zone Committee. Each month the Commandery Chairman is to furnish the Zone Membership Chairman with a list of names of candidates accepted for membership by the Lodge or Chapter (or Council) in the Constituent Commandery territory. This list should show the dates on which the candidates received the Master Mason or Royal Arch degree. Also, report the number of Commandery petitions secured and all other

activities of the Committee. The report should include details of the committee meetings held, also any requests and suggestions of the committee. Constituent and knowledgeable reporting will guarantee considerable success.

LETTER NO. I

Directed to Membe1's of Blue Lodge, Chapter or Council

Dear Brother/Companion:

A wise man will always have a quest for further light. Through each step along the Lodge degrees - Entered Apprentice, Fellowcraft, Master Mason - additional light is sought and expected. But once a frater is Raised a Master Mason, is this all the light he can receive? Masonry is so full of teachings and symbolism that it is impossible to receive and understand it all. Most of it is not found in the Blue Lodge degrees.

In some Grand Lodges, we are told that "the Temple is not yet completed." Later we learn the Master's Word is lost: and a substitute is given. This is the foundation from which we learn that there must be further light and much more to learn of Ancient Craft Masonry.

Some 200 years ago, most of our brethren were known as "Ancient York Masons." When the two Grand Lodges of England United in 1813, a firm and solemn landmark was adopted and placed in the Articles of Union to guide all Masons: "Pure ancient Freemasonry consists of but three degrees, vis., that of Entered Apprentice, Fellowcraft, and Master Mason, including the Supreme Order of the Holy Royal Arch. But this article is not intended to prevent any Lodge or Chapter from holding a meeting in any of the degrees of the Orders of Chivalry, according to the constitutions of said Orders."

At that time, only Past Masters of Symbolic Lodges were qualified to receive the Royal Arch Degree. But it was deemed that this degree was so important that those Master Masons having received the Mark Master Degree should be able to become Past Masters, thus making them eligible to witness the completion and dedication of King Solomon's Temple - and the Royal Arch Degree - where the long lost Master's word is found. These degrees were then taken from the Blue Lodges and established under separate bodies known as Chapters. Royal Arch Chapters confer the Mark Master, Past Master (Virtual), Most Excellent Master, and Royal Arch Degrees.

Royal Arch. Chapters, together with. Councils of Royal and Select Masters (Cryptic Masons), and Commanderies of Knights Templar. compose the York Rite.

The Royal Master and Select Master Degrees in the Council are two of the most beautiful degrees in Masonry and show why the "word" was lost and the secret of its preservation and recovery.

Templary is the Christian Body of Masonry comprised of the Order of the Red Cross, the Order of Malta, and the Order of the Temple. These degrees or Orders as they are called, are beautiful and most impressive and explain the Christian interpretation of Freemasonry. Every Christian Mason should be a Knight Templar!

Further light by means of the most beautiful degrees and Orders is found in the York Rite. After any necessary interval following your third degree, ask for a York Rite petition. (In case you are interested in the Shrine, being a Knight Templar automatically qualifies you.)

Sincerely and fraternally,

III: KEEPING PRESENT MEMBERS

In extolling the merits of Templary to prospective members, keep in mind those members who, because of some problem that has prevented attendance and participation, may need to be reminded of the priceless heritage of Templar membership., Awaken their pride in membership and lend your assistance in all programs and projects in which present members can add their re-activated strength and support.

A dynamic Commandery with energetic leadership and a well-organized and motivated Membership Committee assisting will interest present members and attract new members at the same time.

Where there is weakness, where Commandery planning and programming are ineffectual or absent, lend your constructive support to improving the situation. Words alone don't help; actions do,

How is this accomplished? Two productive essentials are training officers and stimulating the membership.

A. Training the Officers

Generally speaking, every individual WANTS to do a good job of whatever he attempts. In many cases, an officer may miss his goal of achievement because he has not learned - authoritatively and clearly - his duties and responsibilities. It takes a trained instructor to give correct and complete information.

Every Commandery should provide a set of instructions for each officer, outlining specific functional duties of his office in the operation of the Commandery. (Obviously, these are not the duties which appear in the Ritual.) The instructions should include the absolute minimum of what is expected of the Knight holding the particular office, including his committee assignments.

Secondly, all new officers should be exposed to a short, intensive training session conducted by qualified former Commandery officers or Grand Commandery personnel. After these two steps have been successfully completed, ritual assignments and duties can be considered.

Many Commanderies use the appointive officers as a proving ground for training Council Officers and for those members who wish to be active but do not want to progress in line. However, to lengthen the span of continuity, consideration should be given to selecting as Senior Warden the Sir Knight best qualified for Captain General the following year.

B. Stimulating the Membership

One helpful communication gain has been the every-member distribution of the Knight Templar Magazine. Now every Templar, regardless of residence, can find news and views of Templary - to help broaden his Masonic horizon, to motivate greater interest, and encourage a larger understanding.

While the Magazine will help increase his awareness and may inspire even a long-dormant Templar to attendance, personal contact is still necessary and helpful in channeling that renewed interest into activity.

Communicate your own enthusiasm and lend your assistance in having him participate in conferring Orders, if only as a guard or hermit, and taking part in the annual inspection or official visit. He should be given the opportunity to assist in the voluntary Knights Templar Eye Foundation

program, the Knights Templar Educational Foundation work, in DeMolay projects, and local programs. If it is not feasible for him to take an active part, he can at least be made aware of the importance of Templary and its purposes and projects, and what his Commandery is doing. He will become proud of his membership as an active and contributing instrument for good in these times of uncertainty and confusion.

If you are like many of us, in all forms of endeavor, you feel that it's easier to do something yourself than to help influence others to assist in projects and activities. But these things, ESPECIALLY in Christian Masonry, are more productive, more rewarding, and more worthwhile if they are TEAM efforts.

Spread the opportunity to participate; many a man is waiting to be asked. Your efforts in this direction will help make your Commandery consistently and progressively successful.

OBSERVATION

The Committee notes that some Grand Commanderies, particularly those with Division Inspector systems, already have standardized methods of training officers and improving quality and performance. The recommendations and suggestions herein presented - in all categories - are designed to direct immediate attention to membership and leadership with the hope that they will help to create productive activity, whether or not the specific points are applicable in all jurisdictions. The major purpose is to get results!

LETTER NO. 2
Directed to Constituent and Subordinate
Commanders and Membership Chairmen

Dear Sir Knight;

If our Templar Membership Program is to be successful, more of our members are going to have to become involved in the affairs of our Commanderies, and YOU as a leader will have to show the way.

The first step in a successful Membership Program is to keep the members you have.

No man wants to be suspended for non-payment of dues. However, in this day and time, many of our members, because of sickness, old age, or small income, are just unable to pay their dues. When this occurs, their dues should be remitted.

Now we have tried the investigating committee approach for years without much success. This was caused partly because many men are embarrassed by admitting that they cannot pay their dues. Most of the dues reminders that are sent out when a member has not paid his dues are cold and in some cases are downright insulting. Remember, when a member is suspended because of his inability to pay dues, you not only lose the member, but in most cases, you lose an entire family for years to come because his sons and grandsons will always remember that when their dad or grandfather could not pay his dues, he was turned out. When a member pays his dues for many years and then suddenly stops paying, the Recorder should know that something is wrong.

If two months have passed and a member has failed to pay, the Secretary or Recorder should send the member Letter No. 3a (following), which reminds him that he is a very valuable member and that he has probably forgotten to send in his dues; however, if he is unable to pay his dues we still want him as a member. Invite him to just write across the letter that he cannot pay at this time, then remit his dues. If he fails to reply, then two months before he is to be suspended send him Letter No. 3b saying his dues have been remitted and send him his card. Very few men will take advantage of any Masonic body by not paying if they are able to do so.

If YOU really get involved, others will follow. Try it - you'll like it.

Sincerely and fraternally,

LETTER NO. 3a
Directed to Members About to be Suspended for Non-payment of Dues

My Dear Friend and Sir Knight:

Never in the history of this great country of ours has it been so important for men who believe in the things that have made America the greatest country in the world, to remain bonded together in a Fraternity such as our Masonic Order.

The principles and teachings of Masonry are a mighty bulwark against those who would destroy this great country of ours.

You are a very important member of our Fraternity, and even though you may not be able to attend or give the time that you wish, the fact that you by your dues have contributed to our Masonic charities makes you very important to all of Masonry.

We find that your dues for this year have not been paid as yet. If for reason of age, illness or financial difficulty you feel that you are unable to pay your dues, we still want you as a member. Just drop me a line with the simple statement - "I am unable to pay my dues at this time" - and the dues will be remitted for this year in keeping with our Masonic teachings of caring for a worthy Brother.

May our Heavenly Father bless and keep you and yours for many years to come.

Sincerely and fraternally,

LETTER NO. 3b

Directed to Members About to be Suspended for Non-payment of Dues

My Dear Friend and Sir Knight:

You are a very important asset to our Masonic Fraternity, even when you are not able to attend, because our many Masonic charities depend in part on a portion of your dues for their support. However, if our Masonic teaching means anything at all, it means taking care of our distressed Brethren.

We find that your dues for this year have not been received. If for any reason such as age, sickness or financial difficulty you feel that your dues have become a burden, we still want to keep you as a member in good standing.

At our last Stated Meeting, a list of all delinquent members was read, and it was unanimously adopted that the dues for these Sir Knights would be remitted for one year. We are, therefore, most happy to send you your dues card for this year.

We hope that you will accept this dues card as a gift from your Brethren in the spirit in which it is given because we want YOU as a member. When a member's dues are remitted for a year, they cannot be repaid because the member's account has been credited as paid for the year.

May our Heavenly Father bless and keep you and yours for many years to come, and may your membership in our Fraternity be a real joy to you.

Sincerely and fraternally,

GRAND ENCAMPMENT MEMBERSHIP COMMITTEE – February Report

The committee has established specific goals and realistic timelines for accomplishing them. This committee will be working in conjunction with the committees on Electronic Communications, Social Media, and Public and Fraternal Relations as we all labor to improve our efforts to better support our fraternity. We are confident that with the full efforts of every Sir Knight, combined with the support of the GEKT Membership Committee, we will succeed.

The intent of these monthly “newsletters” or reports on the Grand Encampment website is to provide you with the latest directives from our Grand Master, any new items that have been placed in our “toolbox” that will provide you with those ideas, templates and suggestions for promoting membership. These will be broken down into four areas: Recruitment, Retention, Restoration, and Public/Masonic Relations. Some may not like the term “recruitment”, but the idea is there..... that we need to increase our numbers. “Retention” is concerned with keeping the members we have by fulfilling their needs and aspirations. “Restoration” involves our efforts to bring back those Sir Knights we have lost due to a lack of interest or personal issues that may have prevented them from continuing their membership at that point in their lives. Public and Masonic relations are just that, working to promote better relationships and awareness in the communities we live in and a better understanding of who we are and what we stand for among our Masonic brethren. Look for many of these “tools” to appear on this portion of the website in the coming days and weeks.

Who will carry on this work of promoting membership? Every Department Commander was tasked with providing the GEKT Membership Committee with the names and contact information for the Membership Committee Chairman in each of the Grand Commanderies within their jurisdiction. In the coming weeks and months we will be reaching out to obtain the same information for each of the separate commanderies within each Grand Commandery. This organizational chart will enable the central committee to establish more direct lines of communication to those of you who are working at the “ground level” to promote membership. You will be seeing more of us at the Department Conclaves, providing more education, advising on the use of the tools in our “tool box” and listening to you for your comments, suggestions and questions.

As we looked back over several years/decades of reporting and the stated purposes and goals of previous GEKT Membership Committees, we identified several concerns that remain today. There were numerous programs aimed at strengthening our membership numbers which are still pertinent today. Why didn't they succeed? How is it that we still face many of the same problems and that many of the same proposed steps to stem this downward trend. Why haven't those programs been put into play? The answer appears to be that once we had identified our problems and developed the programs to correct them, they were not successfully implemented. We failed to follow through from year-to-year and certainly from one Triennial to the next. MEGM Nelson made it clear that we MUST have continuity in this regard. Once we have identified those Sir Knights who have the demonstrated skill sets and the dedication to work on our membership, we need to keep them at the job for more than just this year. We need to provide them with the necessary tools to assist them, train them on the use of those tools and bring more SKs with similar skill sets into the

program. The job is huge and can be overwhelming at times, much like eating an elephant. You can liken this to turning an enormous aircraft carrier around full. It's a big effort that will require many degrees in making it happen until the new course has been achieved. We need to have our full team involved in this effort, led by ambitious leaders.

We will leave you with this thought which SK Jeff Bolstad, REGCG posted on a daily text he sends out: "Ambition is refusing to give up on ourselves. Leadership is refusing to quit on others." Together, we can achieve great things.

SK Henry Adams, PDC Chairman

SK Carson Smith, member

SK William A. Garrard, PDC member

TAKING INVENTORY – APRIL 15, 2019

by Henry Adams

Companions and Sir Knights,

In Rite Notes, two months ago, you had the opportunity to see what motivates people to join a fraternity. Last month you learned what drives people. Any of those sound familiar?

Undoubtedly you have seen yourself or someone you know in those articles. It is those things that draw people into fellowship. In order to seek membership, they must feel that they will get something out of it. That isn't selfish by any means.

Pleasure and satisfaction is our "pay" for being a member. That is why we pay dues, go to meetings, devote long hours, and endure even the unpleasant times. Ultimately, we are "rewarded" for our good works. That too, is not a negative. It is our motivator.

The positive experiences must outweigh the bad (and there will be negative experiences). In our lodges and York Rite Bodies, we must work to limit negative experiences while offering opportunities for members to feel useful.

How does your York Rite Body fair next to these ideals?

Get out a legal pad and divide it into three columns.

Points	Notes	Items
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First, write down the items from your York Rite Body in the middle column.

These items include:

- Security
- Feeling of Worth
- Feeling of Accomplishment
- Acceptance
- Giving something back to the communities
- Prestige
- Education

In the right-hand column write down what kinds of things your York Rite Body does in these categories. Be specific. Now look over the notes for each category and award your Body points for each category. If you do a good job at it, give yourself a "10". If it's mediocre, maybe a "5". If you don't offer it, then it's a "0".

The maximum number of points is 70. If your York Rite Body is doing really well in all areas, then maybe you're a 70. You have a dynamic Body. If your score is less than 20, you have a major problem. The areas with the lowest scores are areas that need improvement.

Now ask some of your fellow members to take the test and compare answers. This will help you to begin to plot a course for improvement. How can you improve in these target areas mentioned above. Most are surprisingly simple to do, and many are not that costly.

Here are some suggestions:

- **Security** -- Improve the lighting inside and outside the building.

Be sure to investigate new members thoroughly before admitting them. Your investigating committee is supposed to be a safeguard against unsavory types. Just because they breathe doesn't mean that they will be a good member. Don't underestimate the power of personal security.

- **Feeling of Worth**--A little praise can go a long way to making a person an active member. We all seek praise; it is part of the human psyche. We accomplish more when we feel like we're worth something.

Have annual awards dinners, give out framed certificates. Say thank you often. Let people know their efforts mean something to you and the Body.

- **Feeling of Accomplishment**--Celebrate the completion of a degree, project, etc. Shower praise, give congratulations. Do projects that mean something.

Even if the project didn't turn out like you had hoped, or the degree didn't go as smoothly as you would have liked, find something to praise. Everyone wants to feel that what they are working toward is a worthy goal. Celebrate the victories instead of focusing on the defeats.

- **Acceptance**--How accepting is your York Rite Body of new members? If new members feel like outsiders, they will not return.

How often do you make people feel accepted? Welcome them. Shake their hand. Look them in the eye. Call them by name. Find a way to draw a person into the conversation. Be sure someone is assigned to keep an eye for the "wall-flowers" who just sit there by themselves and say nothing. These people are undoubtedly introverts who are probably shy in crowds.

- **Giving back to the Community**--How well does your York Rite Body relate to the community? Do people know about you? Would it make any difference to your town if your group ceased to exist.

Community projects vary from community to community. Each one should meet the individual needs of your town. You can't solve all of your communities' problems, but you can make a dent in them. If each citizen does their share, your city will become a good place to live.

How can you find out what project would be good for your community. Most likely from your new members! They have the freshest perspective.

- **Prestige--** Does it mean anything to belong to your Body besides paying dues? Is there a bit of pride in wearing your pin or ring? Belonging should have a sense of honor to it.
- **Education--** Our members want to improve themselves in Masonry. They want to know more about what it means to be a member of the order.

Get others to sit down over a cup of coffee with a legal pad and brainstorm. Discuss your ideas and you will be on your way to finding solutions to your membership problem.

WHOSE RESPONSIBILITY IS IT TO PAY ATTENTION TO OUR MEMBERSHIP ISSUES?

I fear that too many of us would answer that it is our Recorder who looks after our membership numbers, to know who has or hasn't paid their dues yet this year. But there is so much more than simply calling our fraters who may remain delinquent with their current year dues, let alone the dues notice they just received for 2019. I put it before you that membership is everyone's responsibility. It is up to each and every one of us to look out for the welfare of our fellow Sir Knights.

The message from Sir Knight Jeff Nelson, our Most Eminent Grand Master, is very clear: "Membership is the #1 highest priority for this 68th Triennium. It is also the 2nd and the 3rd highest priority." Soon MEGM Nelson will be issuing a General Order, directing every Grand Commandery to establish a Membership Committee, made up of qualified Sir Knights who have proven to be dedicated to the issue of our membership, who will be given certain goals as to our membership and held accountable to meet those goals. To this end, SK Nelson has laid upon his Grand Encampment Membership team the responsibility to develop a full blown program that will assist all others in achieving this all important goal of reversing the downward trend in our numbers that has plagued us for too many years now.

The Grand Encampment Membership Team is made up of SK Henry Adams of Florida, SK Carson Smith of Indiana and SK Bill Garrard of Arizona. They are working with SK Jeff Bolstad, REGCG to create a "tool box" of programs that can be utilized by all of the constituent membership teams. Think of this program in terms of 4 major categories:

- Recruitment
- Retention
- Restoration and
- Masonic and Public Awareness

Recruitment should be fairly obvious to everyone.....bringing in new Knights. As you think more on it, you realize that this means working more closely with our Chapters and Council and especially our Blue Lodges. But it goes beyond that. Each and every one of us is first a Master Mason who belongs to at least one Blue Lodge. It is equally our responsibility to our home lodge to bring in new candidates, good men and true, to become Masons who may (should) eventually become York Rite Masons and Knight Templars.

Retention, as the word implies, is keeping those members we already have. First and foremost we should concentrate on all of those new Sir Knights to see that they become quickly involved in our Commanderies. This doesn't mean that we put them into an officer's seat right away, but that we "mentor" them at first by teaching them more about what it is to be a Knight Templar.

Retention also means that we should always strive to conduct our stated meetings in a way that holds the interest of our fraters, leaving them wanting to keep coming back. We should always check on our fellow Sir Knights who may have missed several meetings in a row, and to invite them to come back soon.....we miss them. Such a call will also let you know if there is a deeper problem, such as their losing interest in being a Sir Knight or Masonry as a whole or if there may be a family problem or sickness that might be holding them back. Perhaps there is a financial problem, job loss or something that you could help them with. Knowing what has caused their continued absence will go a long way in helping you formulate a plan to get them back. If our Sir Knight has indicated that he is “done with” the fraternity and intends to demit or allow himself to be suspended for NPD, we should always ask where we failed to meet his expectations and if there is anything that we can do to keep him. And in these cases, your final response should be that we wish he would reconsider and that we will make every effort to resolve whatever it is that caused him to lose interest. Let him know that we wish him the best and that we will stay in touch should he ever reconsider his decision.

Over the past decade, the number of demits and suspensions has been the overriding cause of our losses in membership across the board in all jurisdictions. This is the one area that we need to put forth our best efforts to resolve.

Restoration seems to be a case of “out of sight, out of mind” in that the number of restorations throughout the entire Grand Encampment over the past decade has been abysmally small, less than 3/10th of 1 percent. How can we totally ignore those of our members who we worked so diligently to recruit and allow them simply to fade away and never ask them to come back?

And finally, **Masonic and Public Awareness:**

Develop a “lodge ambassador” program whereby you have one of your Sir Knights who is active in his Blue Lodge, Scottish Rite or Shrine there to represent what is going on with your local Commandery. This ambassador should also urge the Worshipful Master of his lodge to allow him to put on brief educational presentations on what it is to be a Knight Templar. Put a team of honor guards together that might do flag presentations or welcoming lines/escorts at officer installations or other important events. It is always advisable to make a public appearance as Sir Knights dressed in our full Class A uniforms at parades and other public events to make the general public more aware of our existence. Every Sir Knight should have his “elevator speech” ready to answer anyone who asks what we are about. What is our “relevance” in today’s world.

Over the next several weeks and months look to the Membership portion of the Grand Encampment website for more information on our “toolbox” of programs and “how to” articles on putting together a successful membership team in your Commandery. We wish everyone of you good luck with your efforts to increase and improve our membership in this fraternity we cherish so much.

MEMBERSHIP

A NEW YEAR , A NEW PURPOSE

Your membership committee has changed its focus and will now be published each month on our Grand Encampment website, with ideas that might be used by the Grand Commandery and its constituent Commanderies to improve our lingering membership. Each month we will bring to you new ideas that might assist the local bodies in growing new members, improve participation, and retaining the members that we current have. It is usually easier to retain members than to recruit new members. We have too many NPD's and Demits. The ideas that we will bring to you may work for your Commandery or may not, but we need to try.

Personal involvement and commitment are minimum requirements for a successful membership process. A knowledgeable sales organization is equally important to insure that we are getting good results. We use the word "sales" because it perfectly describes our tasks at hand, selling membership in an organization whose prime mission is the "Support and Defense of the Christian Religion". No other organization unites all denominations of Christians together for this common cause. Knowledgeable Knights make enthusiastic and successful salesmen because they know the quality of the product and the benefits of ownership. A Knight who is well versed in all aspects of Templary must also "walk the talk" if he expects to be a convincing salesman.

As we move into the 21st Century, the Grand Encampment Membership Committee is redoubling its efforts to train and encourage Knights Templar leadership at all levels to implement the plan and the processes necessary for success. Individual leadership, commitment and accountability are keys to an effective program; but the real key is YOU! Membership recruiting and retention cannot be delegated to committees, or the sole responsibility of the leadership. We must live by the motto, "If it is to be, it's up to me".

As Knights Templar, we have one foe that we must collectively vanquish, and that is apathy. The membership program of the Grand Encampment is an action program designed to perpetuate our organization and it will succeed if all members do their part. We read in Chapter 28 of the Book of Matthew where Jesus commissioned his disciples to "Go ye therefore and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and the Son, and the Holy Ghost". Your Grand Encampment Membership Committee would paraphrase this commission by asking every Knight Templar to, "Go ye therefore and teach all Christian Masons, encouraging them to unite under the banner of Templary". Our Grand Master puts it more eloquently, "Every Christian Mason Should be a Knight Templar"!

We cannot wish away our declining membership; we must be individually accountable for growing our business. Don't wait for somebody else to do what you can do now.

What can you do to improve on this serious problem of growing membership. This will be further discussed in future articles but basically, each Grand Commandery should develop a Membership Committee and with their guidance develop a committee in each of the constituent Commanderies. If the Eminent Commander and his dias officers do not buy into the program,

membership will continue to linger. This committee could be formed by the number two man or a designated member of each of the bodies locally. Remember, membership is the job of everyone not just the Commander. A lodge representative program can also be established locally, to insure that the York Rite Body is represented in every Blue Lodge. Have a petition in your pocket, and know when the next festival is scheduled. Remember, we must get them in the Chapter first then the Council (where required) and the Commandery.

Many different subjects will be discussed in the future, and if there are any questions, please contact a committeeman.

SK Henry A. Adams

SK Carson Smith

SK William Garrard

THE 3 R's OF MEMBERSHIP

RECRUITMENT - RETENTION - RESTORATION

Sir Knights, as we become more mired in the depths of this COVID 19 pandemic, the challenges of a declining membership become even more of a priority for our entire Masonic family. Every Blue Lodge, Chapter, Council, and Commandery needs to work diligently along with our Brothers in the Scottish Rite and Shrine International on the 3R's of Membership. Grand Master Jeff Nelson has declared this to be the number 1 (#1) priority of the 68th Triennium. As we begin our effort to not only recruit new members but equally as important to retain members, each of the constituent bodies of York Rite should be communicating the importance of having Blue Lodge participation. One might wonder why we include the above bodies? If we do not recruit them into the Chapter, we will never see them in Commandery.

The three R's of any campaign are recruitment, recognition, and retention. They are the foundation upon which any campaign must be built. **RECRUITMENT:** The lifeline of any organization is built upon new members. Without a new base of membership, we cannot reach the heights that our valiant and magnanimous Order so richly deserves. We intend to present a workable, viable recruitment program that is a time-tested tool that can lead you to success. **RETENTION:** Often, the only thing a wavering brother needs is encouragement. We can turn the tide of NPD's with a friendly call or visit, informing the member of the importance of his remaining with the York Rite. A phone tree can do wonders in keeping members informed and teaching them that our Order is still relevant and has value for them. **RESTORATION** (or Reactivation) is involved with reaching out to those fratres who we have lost and encouraging them to rejoin Templary Masonry. And let's add a fourth "R" and call it "Masonic and Public Relations", how we should conduct ourselves to present a better picture to all who look upon our proud Order.

RECRUITMENT

Recruitment is the lifeline of every Commandery. Without a dynamic membership base, we cannot reach the heights our Historic, Valiant and Magnanimous Order seeks to achieve..

As one of the "appendant" bodies of Freemasonry, we Knight Templars can only accept Master Masons who have also completed the prerequisite York Rite degrees (i.e. Chapter and Council in most jurisdictions). But we are ALL Master Masons, therefore we can/should be bringing in "Good Men" to join our own Blue Lodges. We shouldn't wait on the Blue Lodges to make new Masons so that we can take them away. We should "mentor" them as they become more founded in basic Freemasonry. We should also concentrate on leading them on their Masonic journey as they "seek light added to further light." Everyone should be encouraged to "find his own quarry" to work in. One certain way is to share with them what we can about York Rite Masonry, how it completes their Master Mason degree in a way and builds on that story.

Each Grand Commandery should carefully consider establishing a LODGE AMBASSADOR program to further education of our non-York Rite Brothers as to who we are as Knights Templar and how the York Rite adds to and reinforces their Masonic careers. A Lodge Ambassador should be one who is not only very active in the York Rite/and Templary, but is also active in his Blue Lodge. Their function would be to let their Brothers know of our scheduled activities, inviting them to our open functions and educational events. These Ambassadors should also be skilled in presenting educational programs within their Blue Lodges as to what the York Rite and in particular what Templary is. All across the Freemasonry in these United States, the numbers of those York Rite Masons as a percentage of all Master Masons in most jurisdictions is far lower than that of our Scottish Rite and Shrine brethren. This alone, represents an opportunity for finding more existing Masonic candidates to join our ranks.

We know that completion of the Royal Arch is a prerequisite to becoming a Knight Templar, as is completion of the Cryptic degrees in most jurisdictions. It then is imperative that our Chapters and Councils should be equally concerned in bringing in new members and encouraging them to complete their York Rite careers by becoming a Knight Templar. The first step here would be the Mark Master degree in the Chapter. Many jurisdictions now offer a "free" Mark Master degree to all interested Master Masons who submit a petition to join the York Rite as a means of giving them a small taste or glimpse at what the York Rite is. We have observed that a program of utilizing the Mark Master degree, well done by a rehearsed degree team when offered to our non-York Rite Brothers has produced some outstanding increases in new members.

You might also consider having your Right Eminent Grand Commander or Eminent Commander send a letter to newly raised Master Masons in their jurisdiction, congratulating them on this momentous occasion letting them know that the York Rite will always be there to assist them on their future journeys through Masonry.

Another approach would be to invite our Blue Lodge, Scottish Rite and Shrine Brothers who are not yet York Rite members, to join with us at dinners and/or educational events that point out the similarities of our separate, but Masonic bodies. I don't know how many of our non-York Rite brothers do not realize how involved and successful Illustrious and Sir Knight Albert Pike was as a Royal Arch Companion and a Knight Templar before he ever became a member of the Scottish Rite. Those of us who are Scottish Rite are well aware of the close connections with several SR degrees as they relate to one another.

Know that it is incumbent on each of us to live our lives honorably, to lead by an example for all to follow. Our success in attracting new members will depend, to a large extent, on how we conduct ourselves and our fraternity in public. A strong and widely advertised public appearance within the communities we reside in can have a very positive effect on our efforts to attract new members.

Attracting new, younger members who have an interest in improving their lives is key to the success of our fraternity. Times and societal mores are constantly changing, notably in how we communicate with one another. We need to strive to incorporate more modern means of communication, such as social media such as Face Book, email, texting and even "Twitter" as a means of reaching out more effectively with the new generations. We want to bring them in to our circles where we can have closer discussions ("mouth to ear" and "cheek to cheek") as we teach our basic tenets and precepts as a means of becoming a better man. The Grand Encampment Committees on Social Media and Education provide some excellent material and ideas to assist you in this area.

Everyone has their own ideas of what recruitment is, there are many successful approaches to how this is best done. We all are different in our own ways and so it is on how we should go about convincing someone to join with us. I believe that we would all agree that honest and forthright communication is an essential key to our recruiting efforts. Listening and learning who we are working with, what they be looking for, what their expectations and desires are and how we might best fulfill those needs is very important. We should always be on the lookout for potential new members and be willing to mentor them through their Masonic careers.

And finally, many of us appreciate the recognition of our labors to grow the fraternity. Go to the website www.knightstemplar.org and click on to the "awards" link to find out more about the Grand Encampment Membership awards program This is an attractive medal, meant to recognize those of our fraters who have been top line signers for new Knight Templars. Be inventive and develop some of your own local awards to recognize exemplary performance by your fratres.

The following pages are examples of letters and suggested programs that encourage Master Masons to become Knights Templar.

The following pages are examples of letters and suggested programs that encourage Master Masons to become Knights Templar.

FIRST CONTACT TO THE NEWLY RAISED MASON

Dear Brother _____,

I congratulate you upon being raised to the sublime degree of a Master Mason! Masonry is full of rich teachings and enigmatic symbolism; it is nearly impossible to receive and understand it all. I encourage you to attend Lodge and witness every degree as often as you can. Every time you attend, you will pick up something “new”, which may have escaped your notice from the time before. The teachings and knowledge from Masonic symbolism we call “Light” or “Divine Truth”. A wise man will always have a desire for the “Light” as you did when you became an Entered Apprentice, then “more Light” as a Fellowcraft, and the “further Light” as a Master Mason.

In the Blue Lodge, its ancient secrets and basic moral principles are only partly revealed. Even when the Master Mason degree is concluded, you are left with only a Substitute Word, but you must plan for the solution of your fraternal and spiritual problems. Remember, “Behold the Temple is not yet completed” and later the Master’s Word is lost, and a substitute given “Until future generations shall find out the right”. This means that there must be “further Light”. And it is my duty to inform you there is! Join the York Rite, today, and discover “further Light”.

From 1717, it was almost a century before the various groups in England were consolidated and the powers and prerogatives of the Grand Lodge were acknowledged and accepted. Still, the tradition that Masonry existed “From time immemorial” persisted. Changes and innovations were vigorously resisted. After years of negotiations and the testing of innumerable degrees that clamored for Masonic approval, the Masons of England formed the United Grand Lodge of England, December 27, 1813, and definitely defined the elements of Ancient Craft Masonry in their General Laws and Regulations as “Pure ancient Masonry consists of three degrees and no more, those of Entered Apprentice, the Fellowcraft, and the Master Mason, including the Supreme Order of the Holy Royal Arch.” The York system is completed in the Knights Templar.

At that time, only Past Masters of Blue Lodges were qualified to receive the Royal Arch Degree. It was then deemed that this degree was so important, Master Masons, who having received the Mark Master Degree, were then able to become (Honorary) Past Masters, thus making them eligible to witness completion and dedication of King Solomon’s Temple, and receive the long “lost Masters Word” in the Royal Arch Degree. In Virginia, Royal Arch Chapters confer the Mark Master Degree, Past Master Degree, Council Degrees (Select Master and Royal Master Degrees), Most Excellent Master Degree, and the Royal Arch Degree.

The Commandery of Knights Templar offers the Chivalric Orders of Christian Knighthood through the Illustrious Order of the Red Cross, Mediterranean Pass and Order of Malta, and the Order of the Temple. These Orders as they are called, are most impressive and explain the Christian interpretation of Freemasonry. Discover for yourself, “Why every Christian Mason should be a Knight Templar.”

The Utah’s York Rite provides that further “Light” through the most beautiful Degrees and Orders in all of Freemasonry given by Royal Arch Chapters, and Commanderies of Knights Templar.

No doubt you have been told, or you will be told eventually, that the degrees conferred in the Blue Lodge embodies the whole of “Light”. That is true, but it is also misleading! The old idiom “the

devil is in the details” meaning that something might seem simple at a first look but will take more time and effort to compete than expected.

Many Masonic scholars agree that the narrative of the Craft, as illustrated in the three degrees, is not the whole story. The Degrees of York Rite Masonry complete the story and provide answers to many questions that the newly raised Master Mason may have. The symbolism of the Royal Arch picks up where the Symbolic (Blue) Lodge leaves off. The symbolism of the Blue Lodge degrees emphasizes the building of King Solomon’s; the Royal Arch Masonry continues in this vein by emphasizing symbols and allegories of the Second Temple, the Ark of the Covenant, a further symbolism of Solomon’s temple completed, and the Lost Word which is given to the Royal Arch Mason. The Commandery Knights Templar Orders have a Christian orientation, their teachings are based on the crusades of the original Knights Templar and are based upon the practice of the Christian virtues, moral values, and spiritual lessons.

Freemasonry teaches us that it is a progressive science, a system of ethics wherein moral precepts is taught by lessons based on the allegorical use of the operative craftsman's tools. Symbolic (Blue Lodge) Freemasonry prepares the candidate in the use of symbolic stone for that Spiritual Temple. Capitular and Cryptic (Royal Arch Chapter) Freemasonry instructs the candidate in the allegorical use of operative tools of the craftsman. Finally, Chivalric (Commandery Knights Templar) Freemasonry instructs in the allegorical use of the weapons in the discharge of the duties of knighthood whereby the Moral Temple, built and restored in Symbolic, Capitular and Cryptic Freemasonry, can be defended and beatified by the precepts of Christianity.

The rich history of York Rite Masonry is undeniable. The York Rite is historically the oldest and purest of the appendant Rites. Every Master Mason should be fascinated by the lessons and mysteries of Freemasonry provided by the Blue Lodge

As a Master Mason, you are entitled to petition the Appendant Bodies of Freemasonry. I look forward to hearing from you soon and again welcome you as a Brother to our Fraternity. Please contact me at:

Phone: _____

e-mail: _____

Sincerely and Fraternally Yours

FOLLOW-UP LETTER TO THE NEWLY RAISED MASON

Dear Brother _____,

By now you should be comfortable in Lodge and gaining experience as a Master Mason. As the Commandery Mentor to our Lodge, feel free to ask me for any help you may need. I know it is not always easy being the “new guy”. The only conciliation I can offer is that we have all been in your situation.

As beautiful and impressive as the Lodge ritual and degrees are, they are far from being everything Masonry has to offer. While the first three degrees teach the cardinal virtues upon which the entire structure of Freemasonry is based, there is more “Light” in Masonry beyond the degree of Master Mason.

I would like to take a few minutes of your time to remind you of the opportunities waiting for you in _____ Commandery No. ____ and the rest of the York Rite. The Commandery meets on _____ at _____ p.m. in the _____ Masonic Temple and the _____ Royal Arch Chapter _____ meets on _____ at _____ p.m. in the _____ Masonic Temple.

Each of the York Rite degrees has its own distinctive character and teaches important lessons in Masonry. However, the Commandery Orders are something set apart from anything you have experienced. They are vastly different in character. The first of the Orders is the Red Cross. It takes place in the time of the Babylonian captivity before the building of the Second Temple. At the end of the evening, a new Order of Knighthood has been created, dedicated to truth. At this point the stage is set for everything that is follow in the next Orders. Before you are created a Knight of Malta, you will be invested with the Mediterranean Pass and learn the history of this Order of Knighthood. Finally, the Order of the Temple is conferred; the only true “Christian” Order. This Order is the longest, most impressive and involving work in Masonry. It asks the candidate to examine his life in the light of his call to a life if integrity, honor and service.

The Commandery actively supports three national philanthropies: The Knight Templar Eye Foundation, The Knight Templar Educational Foundation and The Holy Land Pilgrimage for Christian Ministers.

I hope that you will consider the York Rite and specifically the Knights Templar. I am sure that our work will interest you and we would like you to join with us. We have a lot of excellent work left to do and would welcome your help. I would like to invite you and your lady to be our guests at _____. This will be a good opportunity to meet some of the Commandery members informally and have a wonderful time in the bargain. As you are our guests, there will be no cost to you other than your time, which I hope will be richly rewarded with fellowship.

If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to call me at: _____

With Highest Fraternal Regard

Successful Recruiting Results in Petitions –

Dynamic Leadership Is Needed

By this time, you probably realized building and sustaining a Templar Membership is about LEADERSHIP. Throughout this guidebook, we talk a lot about leadership because a lack of leadership results in failure, and in Templar Masonry, failure is not an option. Recruiting is a no fail mission!

Dynamic leadership is essential as we face inordinate Social and Political challenges and an ever-changing environment. These conditions are characterized by constant change, activity, and directions that create challenges for our Grand/Constituent Membership Teams and they need to think beyond traditional Masonic and Templar progressive activities. We have the critical mission of providing the strength of Templar Masonry by enlisting the best, brightest, and most capable young knights to serve on our Grand/Constituent Membership Teams.

The challenges of our recruiting mission continue to increase; dynamic leadership is critical to success. A lack of leadership or toxic leadership further exacerbates the problem and gets in the way of communicating effectively with Masons and Non-Masons alike, family members, and community centers of influence. An organization void of leadership is also void of trust and confidence. If the Sir Knights perceives a lack of leadership, they will lose trust and confidence in the ability to accomplish the recruitment mission.

Today's recruitment mission is complex and demands good leadership to accomplish our goal of building and sustaining a Templar Membership. Our leaders must remain adaptive, innovative, and resilient. Leadership is a multi-faceted topic, and each facet deserves a column of its own. For now, let me capture the broad scope of leadership in a few bullets:

- Success requires leadership engagement at every Masonic, especially at the Templar levels.

- Our greatest asset is the Sir Knights - we owe them good leadership.

- People expect good leadership; they want leaders who embody Masonic and Christian Values and respect their unique talents and daily contributions.

- Commanderies of Knights Templar with a great ethical reputation attract the best Templar recruiters; they also attract the best Masons, candidates, and most loyal Sir Knights - in our case - Future Fratres.

- Successful leaders embrace Masonic and Christian Values.

- When it comes to ethics, leaders must set the example. Leaders never sacrifice their long-term benefit for some immediate short-term gain by compromising their ethics.

- Emphasize the importance of participation. Our leaders must be innovative, unleash the intellectual capacity of our Commanderies, and ensure every person is involved - take ownership of their portion of the membership goals. Communication is essential; we are all responsible for the success or failure of building and sustaining the Templar Membership.

- Experience has shown that in most cases it is wise to have Membership Team members go in pairs to interview each prospective candidate. The solicitation should always be kept on a professional level and with dignity. It must be remembered that some prospective members are quick to respond, while others need time to think it over. Of course, it is much better to obtain a petition on the first call, but patience is a virtue that may be required to get results.

Each member of the team should know the answer as to fees and if the prospective candidate inquires as to the Knight Templar philanthropies, each Membership Team member should be familiar with the Eye Foundation, Holy Land Pilgrimage, and Education - obtain and familiarize yourself with up to date brochures on our charities. Take copies with you to present to the prospective member. Prospects are entitled to know that that we are daily practicing what we profess.

It is not difficult to sell Templar Masonry. When we are really inspired, do you think for a moment we would doubt our ability to "sell" our magnificent Orders of Knighthood a world that needs everything we stand for? To any timid soul who shrinks from the task, let us assure him that the prospective candidate will thank him repeatedly for his perseverance. After being knighted, he will acknowledge it as an inspiration of a lifetime!

Remember, the number one duty of a leader is to do everything possible to increase membership and sustain his Commander. He should make this his first duty - and follow it up constantly! Just to appoint a Membership Committee is not enough - they must work hard and bring in petitions! Leadership is the number one quality to be looked for in any new Templar Officer, and the leader must devote the major part of his time to the membership functions for which he is qualified.

The saying "leaders are created not born" is true because anyone like you, whatever your abilities are can become an effective leader if you have the right mindset and will. The following dynamic leadership characteristics can save you time and trouble from mistakes that can happen:

Authority in Leadership Characteristics - An important part of effective leadership characteristics is having authority that other people respect - people recognize you as someone who deserves recognition and as someone who is deserving to be followed like a "role model".

A Vision that Moves - Dynamic leadership characteristics require a powerful vision which is not only great but can influence and move people towards the objective and goal of what needs to be achieved.

Communication that Connects - Effective leadership characteristics show how good and sufficient communication can determine the performance of a team. You do not need to be a great speaker or an "orator;" you just need to communicate always and make a stable connection with all team members

Sound Judgement - A good judgment is reasonable, ethical and should be unbiased. How a leader makes a judgment determines the welfare of the group and the results of the task or project being worked on.

Open-Mindedness - This is simply the ability to have unbiased opinions and the willingness to consider other kinds of ideas and alternatives.

Learning and applying these dynamic leadership characteristics makes your Membership Team function better. You can also expect better results and productivity when your Membership Team members are having good harmony with you as the leader and with each other as fellow team members.

WELCOMING THE NEW SIR KNIGHT INTO OUR RANKS

RETENTION

Just as Recruitment is very important in our efforts to grow our fraternity, keeping our fratres active and engaged in Knight Templary is just as vital, if not more so. Unfortunately, our Templary has continuously lost members since 1969. An overview of our membership numbers for the past decade (2010-2019) reveals:

	Numbers	Percent
Knightings	38,336	30.90
Affiliations	15,695	12.65
Restorations	5,484	4.42
Total Gains	59,515	47.97
Demits	25,995	20.95
Suspensions	41,950	33.81
Demits+Suspend	67,945	54.76
Deaths	39,951	32.20
Total Losses	108,645	87.57
Net Losses	49,264	39.71

(note #s do not include adjustments)

Even counting the # of losses due to death, our Demits + Suspensions exceeded our total gains by 8,430. It is obvious that we cannot long survive this phenomenon if we do not reverse this downward trend. We cannot "outgrow" this negative trend with new recruitments alone, but must "guard the West Gate" for our losses due to Demit and Suspension for NPD. How do we accomplish this?

Improved and constant communications with our fraters is of utmost importance. We need to communicate with them through written means (including "snail mail", email, text messages, and even Facebook, TikTok, Discord, and X [Formerly Twitter].) I think most of would agree that face-to-face conversations are the most effective means of communication whenever we have the chance. Whichever method you use at the time, remember that effective communication is two parts listening and one part talking. We should be concise, speak/write clearly, and always strive to be prompt in your responses to written or spoken requests. One method of communication you should employ is a survey format. (See attached New Frater, Member Survey, and a format for a written or verbal survey.)

First, we must know what it is that brought our new fratres to Knight Templary. What is their personal/Masonic background, what desires or expectations do they hold of what it is to be a Knight Templar, and how would they like to become involved (officer, degree team, committee)? Best means of communicating with them (text, email, phone, etc.)? Their top-line signer should be intimately involved with their introduction and induction into the fraternity. He should be made aware of his responsibilities in this regard and assisted in his efforts to support his candidate.

NEW MEMBER SURVEY

Name _____ Lady _____
First Middle Last

Address _____ City _____ State _____ Zip _____

Occupation _____ Email: _____ Tel/Cell #: _____

Hobbies/Interests _____

What induced you to become a Knight Templar?

What are your expectations/desires of us as a new Sir Knight?

How would you like to become more involved in our Commandery (i.e. Committees, Ritual, Officer):

Do you know of any of your Masonic Brothers or any other individual that you think might be interested in becoming a Masonic Knight Templar?

Interviewed by SK _____ Date _____

MEMBER SURVEY

After you first joined the York Rite and progressed through the Chapter and Council degrees, you decided to go on with your Templar Orders. In an effort to learn more from our fratres, we would like to know how you rate our performance. Your feedback will help us in fulfilling your goals and expectations. We would greatly appreciate your comments. This will all be kept anonymous. What were some of your top goals and expectations on becoming a Knight Templar?

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

On a scale of 1-10 (10 being best), how would you rate our performance? Any comments?

1. [] _____

2. [] _____

3. [] _____

What areas have succeeded in? _____

Where have we failed you? _____

Any other suggestions for improvement or comments? _____

What is the best way to contact you and what time of day?

Telephone (cell and/or home) _____

Email: _____

COMMANDERY SURVEY OF INACTIVE SIR KNIGHTS

What were your reasons for joining the York Rite/becoming a Knight Templar?

Please check all that apply. ☐ Family tradition ☐ A close friend encouraged me to join

☐ Historical relevance ☐ Military tradition (i.e. uniform, drill, esprit de corps)

☐ The prestige of being a Knight Templar ☐ Other _____

What were your reasons for dropping your membership?

Please indicate Your number one reason with an * and indicate all others with an X.

☐ Simply lost interest ☐ Just too busy ☐ Too much family time lost

☐ My job is too demanding ☐ Financial difficulties ☐ Too much travel time

☐ Dues are too high ☐ Moved from the jurisdiction ☐ Poor health

☐ The meetings are poorly run ☐ Poor ritual work

☐ Dropped my Blue Lodge membership ☐ Other _____

Were any of goals or aspirations for joining the York Rite/Commandery fulfilled?

☐ Yes. Which were met _____?

☐ No. Where did we fail _____?

While a Member, how often did you attend stated meetings?

☐ Every Month ☐ Every Other Month ☐ Seldom ☐ Never

How Often Did You Attend Festivals? ☐ Often ☐ Occasionally ☐ Never

Were you ever an officer? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, what office(s) _____?

Would you ever consider becoming an active member again? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Could we personally contact you?

☐ Yes Best time/phone or email _____

☐ No. I'm really not interested.

Please Use The Reverse Side For Any Additional Comments

RESTORATION
You Wish To Make
COUNTERING LOSSES DUE TO DEMIT OR NPD

Here is a paper on suggested steps when working on delinquent dues and a suggested telephone protocol for the same.

Initial Phone (or personal contact) Protocol

for calling a Fratre who has not paid his current dues or has not recently attended our meetings

Our first personal contact (either by face-to-face, phone call, email or text) should always be more of a “welfare” call:

We’ve missed you these several months?

Is everything OK with you, your family or job?

Is there anything we can do to help you?

Are you OK?

Is there anything that we have failed you with, have we fulfilled your expectations? _____

(This may be one of the most important lines of questioning in that we need to know where we have let our fratre down or what may have caused him to drop out. We need to identify the problem(s) and work to rectify it.)

We recently sent out our (current year) dues notices.

Did you receive a copy?

If not, do we have your correct email address? _____

If any stated problems, what are they: ____Personal ____Medical ____ Employment

How can we assist you? _____

If there is anything we can do, please call me:

Name/contact information _____

Listen carefully to the individual and show him that we care. Let him know what is going on now at the Lodge/Commandery and invite him back. Remember that effective communication is two parts listening and one part talking. God gave us two ears and only one mouth.

WORKING DELINQUENT DUES

Suspensions are the number one issue contributing to the decline in Membership for the Grand Encampment. Our goal is to hold suspensions and demits under 2% of each Commandery's membership.

Following are ideas and practices that many Commanderies have used to reduce their suspensions. Do not stop or postpone communication to Delinquent fraters, it should be INCREASED.

" When planning your Commandery membership program appoint a committee of dedicated Sir Knights to work with your delinquent members throughout the year. Their job is to encourage your NPDs to remain active, to become more involved in your activities and continue to support the York Rite. This committee is the most challenging job in our Commanderies, they should be recognized at meetings, have name badges, shirt, jacket etc. They are working to keep your Commandery successful, make them feel appreciated. It is imperative to train this committee on all available tools made available by the GEKT. Encourage them to commit to this program for more than just this year. Continuity is a vital part of the program.

" Organize lists of Delinquent Sir Knights for the calling officers, and committee members. Lists need to include all contact information and any pertinent or useful information that you might have. Leave room for the calling officer to record the dates, times and details of their conversations with the NPD member.

" Assign sufficient number of Sir Knights to the NPD committee to get the job done. Each member is given a list of SKs to work until Paid, Remitted or Suspended. They must follow up with multiple calls if needed. Your initial calls should be more of a personal or welfare check, telling the SK that we have missed him at our meetings and asking how his job, family and/or health are doing. You should also let them know about upcoming functions or changes in your meetings that have come about recently. These first calls should let the him know that a Brother is calling to visit and is concerned with getting them more involved again..

" NPD calling committee may want to meet monthly to discuss progress or concerns.

" Consider monthly calls to all Sir Knights with birthdays in that month. Each NPD committee member needs to call his list to wish them "Happy birthday". Make this a Friendly call to visit and ask how they are doing, talk about your Commandery and upcoming functions etc. LISTEN. It's important to take notes on the calls and record comments and feedback for review at committee meetings.

" The Number One reason most Men become Knights Templar is the prestige of being a Templar. Everyone has certain expectations and goals they want fulfilled. It's extremely important that our Commanderies first identify what those are and if they are meeting them to the satisfaction of the Sir Knight. Consider conducting periodic member surveys to learn more from your Sir Knights. This can be one of the most important things this committee can do to determine what may be done to improve the situation.

" Effective communication with NPD members and those who may not have attended your stated meetings or festivals for a long period of time is essential to keeping our Sir Knights involved.

Remember that effective communication can be said to be "two parts listening and one part talking." It is important to find out what the problem may be and how it may best be remedied.

" If you determine that the Sir Knight is seriously considering a demit, remind them that they must be current with this year's dues before they can request a demit. If they remain persistent with a demit, ask them to fill out an exit survey to learn more about why this has happened and if anything can be done to save them.

Other Suggestions:

" Monthly Post Card notice to frater reminding them that dues are still unpaid.

" Consider a "Helping Hands" fund to pay dues for SKs who may be having financial problems.

" Consider sending a suspension questionnaire to delinquent members .(Samples will be made available in the membership tool box found on the GEKT website)

" Find ways to allow payment of dues with credit cards, monthly deductions from their checking accounts, PayPal, etc.

" Show the importance of our dues if we are to be better able to serve the Sir Knights needs and expectations.

Following are some of the 5 most common reasons a Sir Knight may become Delinquent in their dues:

1. Members who have active for many years may tell us they have enjoyed their time with the York Rite, but just don't want to participate anymore. Age, can't drive, traveling, moving etc.
2. Some may tell us that they simply have lost interest in the York Rite, telling us the fraternity is great, it's just not for them.
3. Men that got caught in a joining "frenzy" with friends or family and in some case were helped with initiation cost. Then they get "dues shock" near year end when they receive all the notices for their Lodge dues, Shrine, Scottish Rite and any other dues notices all at once. Or those who feel they no longer have the time to commit to a more active role.
4. Sir Knights that we have lost contact with. Possibly moved away, personal or family illness that we don't know about or worst of all.....have passed on.
5. Sir Knights that have had a life changing event. Illness, family issues, loss of job, etc.

once you have made this contact, record your responses and forward it to the Membership Chairman and Eminent Commander. Be sure to follow up with this frater.

How Can We Enlist Others to Save the Man?

There are probably only three people who can effectively make a difference with a man who has begun to lose interest in Templary. None of them will be effective if the man has decided he does not want to be a member. Let us begin with who can make the most immediate difference.

You! As the leader of the Commandery, you can make his membership meaningful, interesting, and exciting. You and your knights working together can overcome almost any objection. If he is moving, working the night shift, totally without resources or other conditions, you probably will need to consider other arrangements. But if he is too lazy or too bored, you can overcome these objections.

His friends can make a difference. The signers of his petition, his Fratres, those he has met since he joined and others with whom he is close in the Commandery can take him aside and be helpful in

resolving his concerns. It may be as simple as needing a ride or help explaining the organization to his wife and family.

His family: wife, children, father, mother, and relatives who understand why "every Christian should be a Knight Templar" and support his involvement in Templary can answer his questions and support and encourage his involvement.

The Key Idea: The important consideration is that his continued interest and involvement needs to be "of his own free will and accord." Just as it was when he was knighted. Pressuring a man to come back to the Commandery or asking others to bring pressure will not be as effective as learning of his concerns and needs and taking actions to increase his satisfaction. Try these ideas:

Try to determine the single most important reason for his loss of interest in Commandery and Templar activity.

Speak with a close friend or his wife to see where you may have missed an opportunity you can still salvage.

If you do not know where to begin, consider saying to this member, "Look, it seems we may not have handled your membership in the Commander well up to this point. What is there that I can do personally that will make a difference in your decision to leave."

Summing it up: It may sound negative to end this Chapter with a section on losing members. But every Commandery that has members must have a contingency plan to handle those situations when a Sir Knight no longer appears satisfied and supportive of Templar Masonry. Here are some key ideas and suggestions offered to Templar leaders:

As the leader of a Commandery, membership retention is your responsibility.

Members who leave the Commandery can provide valuable insights into the reasons why the Commandery or Templary is not fulfilling the expectations.

Boredom and "sameness" are critical concerns in many Masonic organizations, even in Commanderies, and the leader must take action to eliminate both.

The effective leader can tell when a member is not satisfied by observing his behavior, principally his attendance and aloofness.

Cost of being a Knight Templar - particularly the cost of uniforms, annual dues, Commandery activities, etc.

The effective leader can learn a great deal by having a one-on-one with his members.

Taking actions when the first signs of dissatisfaction appear is critical to changing his direction.

Other members should be asked to solve retention issues.

Knight Templar Festivals present opportunities and challenges.

Time plays a critical role in member satisfaction and interest.

Members who have been inactive for years should be approached very carefully.

Delinquent Members

The increasing numbers of Sr Knights being suspended for non-payment of dues each year is alarming. While we must actively work on procuring new members, we must also be careful to see that once they have joined the Templar Fraternity, they will not become disenchanted and show up on the suspension list after a few years. The Commandery Membership Chairman assigned to RETENTIONS should obtain from the Recorder a list of all Fratres who are in arrears. This should be done shortly after the beginning of each year.

A letter from the Recorder of the Commandery to those Members on the list to advise that their dues are in arrears and to encourage remittance of same. A follow-up letter from the Commander of the Commandery could be sent to those who have not yet responded after a certain period.

For the Members who have still not responded, the most successful method is PERSONAL CONTACT - either in person or by phone. Although the Commander, other officers of the Commandery, or a Past Commander, could contact the Sir Knight perhaps it is best for his petition signers (if possible) or a member of the Commandery Membership Committee. Preferably a Member who is acquainted with him should make contact. In some cases, a Frater is unable to pay his dues because of financial reasons. In these situations, the Commandery could remit his dues. Remember, the Masonic principals of brotherly love, relief and truth should not allow a member to be dropped from the roles for non-payment of dues. The names of those who need assistance must be maintained in the strictest of confidence.

FIRST LETTER (TO BE SENT FEBRUARY OF THE YEAR)
DIRECTED TO MEMBERS ABOUT TO BE
SUSPENDED FOR NON-PAYMENT OF DUES

MY Dear Friend and Sir Knight

Fraternal Greetings.

The Grand Commandery of Knights Templar of Virginia Section 27 requires that annual dues be paid by December 31 for the upcoming year.

Never in the history of this great country of ours's has it been so important for men who believe in the things that have made America the greatest country in the world, to remain bonded together in a Fraternity such as our Masonic Order. The principles and teachings of Masonry are a mighty bulwark against those who would destroy this country of ours.

You are a very important member of our Fraternity and the Commandery of Knights Templar, and even though you may not be able to attend or give the time you wish, the fact that you by your dues have contributed to our Knight Templar charities make you very important to all of Templar Masonry.

We find that your dues for this year have not been paid of yet. If for reason of age, illness, or financial difficult you feel that you are unable to pay your dues, we still want you as a member. Just drop me a line with the simple statement – "I am unable to pay my dues at this time" – and the dues will be remitted for this year in keeping with our Masonic and Christian teachings of caring for a worthy Brother and Sir Knight. May our Heavenly Father bless and keep you and yours for many years to come.

Sincerely and fraternally,

SECOND LETTER
(TO BE SENT APRIL OF THE YEAR)
DIRECTED TO MEMBERS ABOUT TO BE
SUSPENDED FOR NON-PAYMENT OF DUES

MY Dear Friend and Sir Knight

Fraternal Greetings.

The Grand Commandery of Knights Templar of Virginia Section 27 requires that annual dues be paid by December 31 for the upcoming year.

You are in arrears for dues amounting to \$_____.

We are all proud to be members of this Commandery of Knights Templar where many friendships have been formed. We do not want to lose you, and urgently request that immediate payment be made, or that you should reasonable cause why the dues be remitted.

Please contact me so we may resolve this matter.

Sincerely and fraternally,

RESTORATION or REACTIVATION

A quick review of the GEKT membership statistics over the past two decades indicates that we have a very low success rate in bringing those members who have left our ranks back to the fraternity. It is almost a case of "out of sight - out of mind." Think of this: we spent years of time and effort to encourage a Brother to become a Knight Templar, why would we want to simply let them go with a Demit or a Suspension for NPD without knowing how or why we lost him? And then there is the case of that member's personal and financial investment into becoming a Knight Templar, the time going through the Orders and the cost of his new regalia. He obviously was highly motivated to become a Knight Templar, but what caused him to lose interest? In the previous two sections, we impressed the need for occasional surveys to gauge how much we are fulfilling the expectations of our fratres. Always conduct a survey of any Sir Knight who indicates that he is either thinking of demitting or allowing his membership to be terminated for NPD. This is a vital aspect of reaching out to the one who we have lost as we try to bring them back in. These "lost" Templars represent an opportunity to recover someone who already understands who we are and what we stand for.

Our Sir Knights suspend their membership because they stop paying their dues, simple enough. But, why do they do this? There may be several good reasons:

- 1) They have suffered a temporary set-back (i.e. family illness, loss of a job, moving, a financial burden that has been suddenly put upon them, etc.)
- 2) They lose interest- our York Rite/Commandery activities lose their allure or we have failed to meet his expectations in some way.
- 3) Being a Knight Templar no longer has a strong enough meaning or relevance to them.
- 4) They feel that they have been ignored or offended in some way.
- 5) They feel that the York Rite/Commandery has failed to deliver what we promised in terms of fellowship, friendship or fraternity.

The last two are often the toughest to argue.

When you contact a former member about coming back, either by phone or face-to-face, try doing the following:

- 1) Tell him why you are calling (a welfare check, how is he and his family doing or simply to say that you have missed him) and listen closely to what he has to say.
- 2) If he says he is too old, too ill, or no longer has the money, this may be a temporary set back that can be resolved in the future. Tell him you understand, but that there are ways that we may be able to help him and ask if he would mind if that help was offered. (Let your Commander and Recorder know his circumstances.)
- 3) If he has lost interest in our activities, tell him about the things the Commandery is now doing and be upbeat about it. Tell him about some of the new activities: e.g. drill practice, family dinners, educational presentations, etc.

- 4) If he relates negative feelings about the Your Rite in general or the Commandery in particular, ask him to expand on this and how this may be remedied.
- 5) This last one is easy. Offer to be his friend and offer to help deliver on those promises. But, do not do it if you are unwilling or unable to follow through to get him the help he needs or the changes you have explained to him.

SURVEY OF A SIR KNIGHTS WHO HAVE DEMITTED OR REQUESTED A DEMIT

_____ COMMANDERY SURVEY OF A SIR KNIGHTS WHO HAVE DEMITTED OR REQUESTED A DEMIT

What encouraged you to join the York Rite and become a Knight Templar?

Please check all that apply. ☐ Family tradition ☐ A close friend encouraged me to join

☐ Historical relevance ☐ Military tradition (i.e. uniform, drill, esprit de corps)

☐ The prestige of being a Knight Templar ☐ Other _____

What were your reasons for dropping your membership?

Please indicate Your number one reason with an * and indicate all others with an X.

☐ Simply lost interest ☐ Just too busy ☐ Too much lost family time

☐ My job is too demanding ☐ Financial difficulties ☐ Too much travel time

☐ Dues are too high ☐ Moved from the jurisdiction ☐ Poor health

☐ The meetings are poorly run ☐ Poor ritual work

☐ Dropped my Blue Lodge membership ☐ Other _____

How would you rate us on a scale of 1-10 for how we have done so far in meeting your expectations for joining? _____ (10 best)

How have we succeeded? _____

Where did we fail? _____

While a Member, how often did you attend stated meetings?

☐ Every Month ☐ Every Other month ☐ Seldom ☐ Never

How Often Did You Attend or participate in Festivals?

☐ Often ☐ Occasionally ☐ Never

Were you ever an officer? ☐ Yes ☐ No

If yes, what office(s) _____?

Would you ever consider becoming an active member again? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Could we personally contact you? ☐ Yes Best time/phone or email _____

☐ No. I'm really not interested.

Please Use The Reverse Side For Any Additional Comments You Wish To Make

THE PURPOSE OF A YORK RITE FESTIVAL

The Primary reasons for a York Rite Festival are these:

1. To encourage Chapters, Councils, and Commanderies to assist each other by working together in a joint effort;
2. To furnish busy prospective candidates an opportunity to obtain the York Rite within a shorter period of time;
3. To inspire improved ritual and tactics and to stimulate formation of special teams and casts.

One means of encouraging Chapters, Councils and Commanderies to work together is the formation of a local YORK RITE COORDINATING COUNCIL with active participation from Chapter, Council and Commandery. The York Rite Coordinating Council idea has been successfully tried in various parts of the country. It has been demonstrated beyond doubt that it is a substantial step toward coordinating and conserving efforts to achieve the goal of a successful York Rite Festival - not to mention other desirable benefits.

Masons are too busy these days to linger for months, or even years, while taking their York Rite work piecemeal. Hence, more candidates can be obtained through the use of the York Rite Festival which is streamlined and compact in giving all the work in a short period of time. Group psychology has proved over and over again that whatever attracts many men at one time will be more appealing to join than something which interests only one man occasionally.

To inspire improved ritual and tactics is vitally important. No stone should be left unturned to inspire better York Rite work by every legitimate means. The time has come when the York Rite work must have ritualistic work that is performed with dramatic and beautiful execution. Also, the "floor work" must be polished-up and perfected. A York Rite Festival, with a selection of the best possible cast, and with specially selected teams, will give an exemplification of the Degrees and Orders that can't fail to impress candidates. It will give them lessons which the ritual was intended to convey. Also, it will hold the attention and interest of members on the sidelines, who will reflect justifiable pride in their Masonic work being performed with perfection.

Men will flock to join and become members of a "class" which is "going 25 through together." We must capitalize on this strong desire to join with a group and get the work within a shorter period of time.

EXEMPLIFICATION OF RITUAL

The Orders of Knighthood are generally conceded to contain the most beautiful and impressive ceremonies in all the realm of Masonry. The conferring of the Orders is the method by which Christian Masons are enlisted and sworn to duty as a part of our militant corps.

Accordingly, the Orders of Knighthood ought always to be conferred in a dignified and impressive manner. Any less is not only to cheat our petitioners, but to fail miserably in our duty. No detail of preparation should be neglected. No Sir Knight selected to perform these important tasks should take them lightly or permit any other activity to prevent their performance in keeping with the best traditions of our Order.

Unfortunately, in too many places the conferring of our Orders has been allowed to become a matter of routine, conducted without apparent feeling, and performed by a few who happen to be "in the line" or who are available by reason of regular attendance. Where this exists to any extent, we urge thoughtful consideration of the following suggestions:

1. The Ritualistic Program should be planned.

Far in advance, before any candidates are in view, this program should be planned. In most Commanderies, there should be three ritualistic cycles per year - two at home and one area Festival. A large and active Commandery might need one more. There is rarely any planned campaign for the enlistment of new members in the absence of a planned ritualistic program. Consider how embarrassed a devoted Sir Knight must be - having just convinced a Christian Mason that Templary is for him and needs him - when he is unable to give a satisfactory answer to the natural and unfailing question of the important prospect or anyone who has other demands upon his time: "When would I receive the work and how much time will it require?"

2. The Program Should be Coordinated.

First, it should avoid conflicting dates. Thus, we would not be conferring work while Grand Lodge is in session, or on the same night when there is a reception for the Grand Master anywhere in the close area, or on nights when local students are graduating. Second, we should not plan Templar work just before the Chapter and Council work is to be done, or just after a Shrine ceremonial, if we can avoid it.

3. We Should Use our Best Ritualists.

The use of ritualistic casts in all of the Orders is recommended. These Sir Knights need not be the officers of the Commandery. There are several good reasons for this practice:

- (a) more members may be used, thus both spreading the work and permitting more members to contribute to the program;
- (b) the principal officers of the Commandery are relieved of their demanding parts, unless they wish to take them. If they are doing their leadership job, they scarcely have time!
- (c) a clearer differentiation between leadership and ritual is made, and thus we need not, on one hand, prevent a splendid leader from functioning just because he is a poor ritualist, nor, on the other hand, settle for a poor ritualist in order to get a good leader;
- (d) by and large, if we use those who can give the best performance, use more men, with less turnover in personnel, better ritualistic work will result.

4. Our Equipment Should be in Good Order and Ready for Use.

The considerable amount of regalia and paraphernalia used in Templar work represents a large investment, and it must be ready and in good order when needed. This cannot successfully be

"anybody's job." An equipment custodian should have this function: to store the equipment properly; to see that it is clean, complete and in good condition; to bring it out when needed; to check it and put it away afterward:

5. Ritualistic Performances Should be Staged.

The Commandery needs a "Director," a "Stage Manager" and a "Prop Man" just as in any other performance. We ought to understand that you can't put on a "show" by the efforts of the "actors" alone. Someone has to select the casts, train them, see that they know in plenty of time when they are to perform, and know they will be there or provide alternates. Someone has to set up the stage, see to the lighting, change the scenes, etc. Much can be done toward a better performance by the use of local lighting to identify different scenes, by the use of music, etc.

6. The Candidate is the Audience.

Everything is properly played to him. No activities of the sideline members, either inside or outside the asylum, should be allowed to distract his attention. During or after the work, there may well be some social function, at which he will be honored

7. One-Day Festivals,

It is becoming the general consensus of opinion that there is a place in our thinking for one-day York Rite Festivals. All are agreed that this type of ritualistic expedient is not intended to replace the normal full-form conferring of Degrees and Orders at other times during the year.

It is generally believed that many busy men, from farmers who find it almost impossible to leave their fields for several days at a time or at an early hour on seven or eight different occasions to receive the Degrees to business and professional men who cannot always leave their offices for a similar period of time, find it impossible to participate in the York Rite in the normal manner. Conversely, we are aware that one-day festivals seem to attract goodly numbers of Brethren who might not otherwise petition the York Rite. While membership alone is not the goal of the York Rite, we must have both numerical and financial stability in order to promote the high ideals of York Rite Freemasonry.

DRILL TEAMS

A part of the program of every Commandery should be the organization, equipment and maintenance of a Drill Team. Whether it is called a Triangle Guard, the Commander's Escort, or a Drill Team, the function is the same, and very essential.

Such a unit is a requirement of the Constitution of Grand Encampment: "Each Constituent or Subordinate Commandery shall maintain a unit, or units, equipped with full Templar uniforms . . . to be worn at full form openings, and at the conferring of the Order of the Temple." It performs many other useful functions such as ;

- (1) providing escorts for all Commandery functions,
- (2) serving as the backbone for participation in all public appearances, including Divine Services,
- (3) an immediately available assignment and training-ground for new members,
- (4) a trained and basic cast for the Order of Malta and Order of Red Cross,
- (5) a source of available officer material.

Once started, there is no problem in enlisting Templars to join a Drill Team and participate in this recreational and pleasurable activity. The service performed is so valuable that recognition is immediate. Usually, the members of the team are listed with the officers of the Commandery in the bulletins and programs for Commandery events. Every member is aware of the service performed and is correspondingly appreciative.

The size of a Drill Team depends upon the size and interest of the particular Commandery. In a very small Commandery, it could be as few as twelve with a leader. In a large Commandery, it should embrace at least ten percent of the membership.

If there "isn't room" in the Drill Team for new members - room should be provided!

If the spirit of the Drill Team has advanced to the point where they may wish to attend the Annual Conclave of the Grand Commandery and march in the procession to the Divine Service and in the street parades, every encouragement should be given them. With practice, they might even wish to engage in competitive drills. There is nothing that builds the morale and spirit of a Drill Team any quicker than to attend the Annual Conclave and take some part in its events. The companionship and close association with other Sir Knights begets a kindred spirit that nothing else can furnish.

If the morale and spirit of a Drill Team should indicate a desire to appear in force at a Triennial Conclave of Grand Encampment to march to Divine Service, to compete in the drill competition or to march proudly with thousands of other Templars as they witness their Christian faith, the local Commandery should be happy to support its Drill Team by providing transportation and some of the other necessary expenses.

Competition with others is a natural desire of a Drill Team as it develops pride in its accomplishments. It is not necessary that a Drill Team should be entered in a national competition which requires weeks and months -of training under an expert. A Drill Team is something that is flexible enough to make its own choice as to how intensely it will prepare itself and to what extent it will aspire. It is possible for any two or more teams to compete, either locally for the entertainment of the members of the respective Commanderies, on the District level as a feature of the District Festival, at the State level in connection with the Annual Conclave or nationally at the Triennial

Conclave. The surprising thing about a Drill Team is that it will automatically stimulate its Commandery to greater activity. Also a Drill Team will be the nucleus for the making of a pilgrimage that will benefit the Commandery and every Sir Knight in it. At the same time, every member of the Drill Corps will be involved in wholesome recreation and personal pleasure.

KNIGHTS TEMPLAR CROSS OF HONOR AWARD

At the 49th Triennial Conclave of the Grand Encampment, authorization was given for the granting of a new award to be known as the "Knights Templar Cross of Honor." Each Grand Commandery receives at least one award per year. The larger Grand Commanderies receive one per every 10,000 members or a greater fraction thereof. Subordinate Commanderies considered together are entitled to receive no more than one such award in any one year. The award is to be made upon the basis of the following criterion: that the Sir Knight "shall have rendered exceptional and meritorious services to the Order of Knights Templar, far beyond the call of duty, and beyond the service usually expected of an Officer or Member." Nominations will be made by Constituent Commanderies to the Grand Commander who will decide from all nominees submitted to him the Sir Knight to be recommended from his jurisdiction to the Grand Master, who will have charge of granting the award and issuing a formal certificate along with the Knight Templar Cross of Honor Medal which will be sent to the Grand Commandery to present to the recipient at a ceremony to be arranged in his honor, generally at the Annual Conclave.

This award should stimulate still greater efforts by Knights Templar all over the Templar World to win this coveted honor and to be recognized by the beautiful certificate presented at a ceremony in his own jurisdiction and allowed to wear the Knight Templar Cross of Honor medal on his uniform during the rest of his life.

Each Grand Commandery should appoint a Committee on the Cross of Honor Award - to have charge of the handling of all details for this impressive Templar award.

It should be stressed that the Knights Templar Cross of Honor is designed to be awarded for outstanding Templar service. It is not designed to be given for attaining a high rank in Templar offices. The nominee may never have held any office. He should be one who has given of his time and effort "far beyond the call of duty" for the good of the Order.

MAKING TEMPLARY VISIBLE

PUBLIC RELATIONS

In the fast-moving age in which we live, every activity is striving for public attention. Templary cannot afford to hide its light under a bushel. Certain facts about the purpose of Templary and our great religious and charitable contributions should be portrayed in a dignified manner. In short, the image of Templary should be built up and strengthened by the kind of public relations that convey the right impression and tell the true story to the world.

Whenever we speak of public relations there are those who think only of the modern media of radio and T.V. However, let's be frank with ourselves - the best public relations start with our own selves. The conduct of our own Sir Knights in their constant contact with the public is our most important method of conveying the true image of Templary. If we live up to our high calling - and demonstrate through our lives and conduct that Knights Templar are gentlemen - men who practice what they preach - we will create an image that is worth more in the long run than all the modern publicity media combined. Therefore, our first concern must be that the true image of Templary should be clear in our own minds and in the minds of our members before we try to educate the minds of the general public.

However, it is still necessary to adopt methods that reach the general public and educate them as to our mission and our achievements. This is a field for experts in public relations. Accordingly, the Grand Encampment has decided to be guided in this respect by the counsel and professional services of men specially skilled in this modern art. We intend to carry out a program which will provide instruction and material to assist Grand and Constituent Commanderies to convey the Templar Story to news media - radio, T.V., and newspapers - upon a local level where it will yield immediate and tangible benefits. When the public realizes the potential of Templary for good in every community, as well as its actual day-by-day humanitarian and charitable contribution, there is bound to be a better image of our great Order of Knighthood and a wider acceptance of our true stature.

The Committee on Public Relations has prepared 16 mm sound/color films for program use in Commanderies. They are available on a free loan basis from the Grand Encampment office in Chicago. Advance bookings are necessary.

It is hoped that public relations programs will have immediate and enthusiastic cooperation at all Templar levels. The appointment of a Committee on Public Relations by each Grand and Constituent Commandery should be made at once and the chairman should be instructed to contact the Grand Encampment Committee on Public Relations for further details.

The Grand Encampment "Guidelines on Publicity and Public Relations" is available without charge upon request to the Grand Recorder's office, Chicago.

GUIDELINES for PUBLICITY and PUBLIC RELATIONS

*Taking
The mystery
Out of
Public Relations*



Committee on Public Relations
Grand Encampment of Knights Templar
of the United States of America

Reissued- January 1992

I. PREAMBLE

Woodrow Wilson was asked how much time he needed to prepare a ten-minute speech. His answer, "Two weeks." When asked how long it would take him to prepare a one-hour talk he replied, "I'm ready now."

The example also applies to writing. It is easy to ramble, to ignore limitations of space and length. It takes considerable effort to concentrate on essentials, to organize information in an orderly fashion, and to condense a composition.

Wordiness in writing, as in speaking, generally needs to be avoided. There can be exceptions but benefit usually results if needless words are eliminated. Facts of information are the basis of publicity and public relations, and these are projected more clearly if they are not beclouded with an overabundance of words.

There are other points of importance. Some of them are covered in the following suggestions and recommendations. The Committee respectfully submits these guidelines for your consideration and asks your indulgence if a number of the listings appear to be elemental.

Originally Prepared by the Grand Encampment
Committee on Public Relations (1967-70 Triennium)

Warren H. Deck, P.G.C., New York
Samuel J. Chapman, P.G.C., Montana
Paul C. Rodenhauser, Grand Recorder , Chairman

II. BASICS

A RESUME OF RANDOM DO'S AND DON'TS

1. DO know your subject before you try to tell anyone else about it.
2. DO learn to know your media, and the correct contact at each; learn what they will use, how they want it prepared, and when they want it.
3. DO be brief! It's easy to ramble and fill space. It takes more work to organize facts and keep them condensed, but you'll get a better reception, and more beneficial results.
4. DO remember the essentials - Who, What, Where, When and Why; sometimes How (*).
5. DO be prompt, reliable, accurate, and LEGIBLE!
6. DON'T trust your memory. Train yourself to make notes of the vital facts - especially names, dates, and locations.
7. DON'T use a news release to express an opinion, or to sell tickets, or to plug door prizes or a raffle.
8. DON'T ask the publication for clippings - or, unless absolutely necessary, to return pictures. Make it easy, not difficult, for your material to be used.
9. DON'T ask your news media contacts to buy tickets or to pay their own admissions.

The Final Test

Ask yourself this question: "If I were not a member of this organization, would I be interested in reading this story?" If your answer is NO, the experts tell us to skip it.

(*) Rudyard Kipling, as you will recall, put it this way:

I keep six honest serving-men;
(They taught me all I knew)
Their names are What and Where and When
And How and Why and Who.

III. THE PUBLIC RELATIONS COMMITTEE OF THE GRAND COMMANDERY

- C. Primary purposes of the Grand Commandery Public Relations or Publicity Committee:
 - 4. Maintain flow of news and information on Grand Commandery and Grand Encampment activities, projects and personnel to:
 - a. Templar membership of jurisdiction.
 - b. General Masonic membership of jurisdiction.
 - 5. Interpret and publicize the aims and philanthropies and notable events of the Order to the public.
 - 6. Maintain contact with Public Relations Committees of Constituent Commanderies and provide them with:
 - a. News information or releases for adaption and use at the local level.
 - b. Continuing suggestions and publicity examples.
- D. Methods and Media.
 - 2. Write releases and distribute to newspapers, radio stations, television stations, and area publications generally; Masonic papers, magazines and bulletins.
 - 3. Prepare copy for short talks on Templar projects for presentation, as needed, at meetings of service clubs and civic groups - as well as for use in Masonic gatherings.
 - 4. Possibly, where feasible, prepare and distribute direct mail letters of announcements to Masonic members and bodies.
- E. Organization and Structure.
 - 1. Step One: Compile a list of Chairmen of Constituent Commandery Public Relations or Publicity Committees - with addresses and phone numbers.
 - a. Note the home Commandery of the Grand Commander, and each of the other officers, as a guide to news distribution.
 - b. If Constituent Commanderies have no Public Relations Committees, consult the Grand Commander regarding the need and desirability of such committee.
 - c. Notify Chairmen of existing Public Relations Committees of your aims and planned method of procedure. Ask them, when newsworthy events occur or are planned, to notify you.
 - 2. Step Two: Compile a list of publications in the area - Masonic and non-Masonic.
 - a. List their deadlines and publication dates.
 - b. List contact at each - with name, address, and phone number.
 - c. Make a personal or written approach to each regarding specifications,
- A. picture possibilities, attitude, and general procedure.
- B. Step Three: Compile a list of radio and television stations,

- a. Make contact and learn requirements and possibilities. In general, television and radio - if news opportunities are not always available - will incorporate "news announcements" in catch-all programs such as "Calendar of Events" which can be helpful.
- C. Step Four: Consult the schedule of activities and projects of your Grand
- D. Encampment, Grand Commandery, and the Constituent Commanderies and plan tentative preparation-and-release schedule to match.
- E. Step Five: Get a supply of paper for releases - "newsprint" quality, not expensive, and have it imprinted:
 - a. Identification of Grand Commandery.
 - b. Your name, title, address, and phone number.
 - c. Space for release date designation.
 - d. Designated space for the current date.
- F. Step Six: Start a "morgue" or "library" of current facts, figures, biographical material, fact sheets on the Educational and Eye Foundations, pictures, rosters, and similar reference material.
 - a. Helps you compile releases and announcements with accuracy and completeness.
 - b. Eliminates the possibility of overlooking informational details which belong with the story.
 - c. Saves time and effort.
- D. Examples of Jurisdictional Publicity Opportunities or Events.
 - I. Annual Conclaves (advance and follow up).
 - 2. Installations, especially public.
 - 3. Easter Sunrise Service.
 - a. Check the possibility of radio or television coverage if yours is a state or area event for the public and warrants such coverage.
 - b. Suggestion: Ask your area radio stations to carry the NBC radio pickup of the Grand Encampment Easter Sunrise Service from Arlington, Virginia preferably by delayed audio tape. A later hour is more feasible for the station and more conducive to a larger audience.
 - 4. Anniversaries of significance.
 - a. Grand Commanderies.
 - b. Constituent Commanderies.
 - c. Office or membership anniversaries of prominent members.
 - d. Other bodies of Masonry (which Templary can salute!).
 - 5. Visits by Grand Encampment and Grand Commandery officers.
- G. Knights Templar Eye Foundation cases or large institutional contributions-.
- H. Knights Templar Educational Foundation figures.
- I. Youth group activities - DeMolay, Jobs Daughters, Rainbow for Girls, etc.
- J. Commandery involvement in community events.
- K. Templar flag raisings.
- G. 11.~Templar or Masonic cornerstone ceremonies.

- L. Awards or recognition to individual Templars for "outside" activities and accomplishments - in the profession, in the community. (Be sure Knight Templar membership is included in coverage.)
- M. Outstanding Knight Templar awards, such as Knights Templar Cross of Honor.
- N. Almost any event distinguished by:
 - a. Large number of participants.
 - b. Association with community projects.
 - c. Prominent personages.
 - d. Religious significance.
 - e. Historic connections.
- E. Reminders and General Suggestions for Grand Commandery Committee.
 - 1. Maintain a scrapbook for your records.
 - 2. When you prepare a report, stress recommendations for the future, not primarily what you have done in the past.
 - 3. Releases and information to Constituent Commandery committees should be accompanied by a self-addressed card permitting a return report on use or non-use.
 - 4. Establish lines of communication with Grand Officers and Committee Chairmen in order to receive a flow of information.
 - 5. Because much of the material (and much the same process) applies to Constituent Commandries as well as to the Grand Commandery, don't neglect close contact with local committees.
 - 6. Help correlate news for *Knight Templar Magazine* by publicizing the name and address of the appointed State Editor so information is sent to one source.

IV

THE PUBLIC RELATIONS COMMITTEES OF THE CONSTITUENT COMMANDERIES

A. Four important considerations for the Public Relations Committee of the Constituent Commandery:

1. Media Contacts.

Newspaper, magazine, bulletin, radio, television.

2. Self-Organization.

Prepare yourself and your equipment.

3. Selection of Newsworthy Events.

Don't try to make a mountain out of a molehill.

4. Preparing the Material.

Provide information, not wordage.

B. Media Contacts.

1. Get to know your contacts.

- a. Make a visit, but don't stay long. They have deadlines to meet.
- b. Let them know that you represent the Commandery in the field of news.
- c. Leave a neatly typewritten sheet listing your name, address, and phone number, the identification of your Commandery, and the names and titles of the officers.
- d. Ask about pictures - whether they provide, or you do.
- e. Ask about the form of material they desire.
- f. Learn their deadlines.
- g. Ask about anything you don't understand in regards to your connection with them.

2. Your job is. to provide them with news information or articles that they can use; their job is to tell you what they can use. (Don't fuss if they change or shorten. That's their privilege.)

C. Self-Organization.

1. Don't handle publicity stories or public relations in general by impulse, whim, or sudden inspiration.

- a. Indoctrinate yourself to think in advance.
- b. Prepare yourself with the practical tools:
 - 1) Typewriter and paper.
 - 2) Dated notebook.
 - 3) Scrapbook (for clipping files).
 - 4) Roster of Commandery Officers and Committee Chairmen.
 - 5) Schedule of the year's programs and events.

- 6) Descriptive and statistical information on the Knights Templar Eye Foundation, Educational Foundation, and any special projects in your area.
 - 7) List of names and phone numbers of your media contacts.
2. Plan your own schedule (and/ or the members of your committee) so that activities of expected news value will be covered.
 3. Work with your Officers, Committee Chairmen, and project leaders so you know the background information in advance of the event.
 4. Start collecting a picture and bio file of individuals and information on objects having a possible connection with news releases.
 5. Keep in touch with your Grand Commandery Committee on Public Relations for information and assistance.
 6. As the public relations man, you should know the answers to these and many others: "What is a Knight Templar?" - "What is Knight Templary?" - "What does it do?" - "Is it something like the Shrine?" - "How does the Eye or Educational Foundation work?" - "What is the Grand Encampment?" - "How old is the Order?" - "What does 'A.O.' mean?" - "Why do you have titles such as 'Commander', 'Generalissimo,' and 'Captain General'?"
- D. Selecting Newsworthy Events.
1. Study your Commandery's schedule for the year.
 2. List the activities you think will be newsworthy.
 - a. Make advance notes about possible pictures.
 - b. Where speakers and performers are involved, collect biographical background in advance.
 3. Skip the routine. There are ways and means of listing regular and routine items - but don't make "news" stories out of them.
 4. In making your decisions, use this question as the real test of any article's news value: Will it interest non-members in your community?
 5. Among the things that make news:
 - a. A large class of candidates.
 - b. A prominent speaker.
 - c. A service or ceremony to which the public is welcomed.
 - d. Collective or individual Knight Templar participation in a community project.
 - e. A significant anniversary.
 - f. Election and installation.
 - g. In other words: special events, special people, special circumstances.
 - h. Activities of prominent local Templar - each time he gets recognition or gives it see that his Templar membership is mentioned.
 6. If your Commandery does nothing, there is nothing to publicize. In such a case, the Commandery needs more than Public Relations.

You are then in a position to offer suggestions for possible programs which will have news value.

7. In your "news thinking," do not overlook any DeMolay possibilities --- and related groups; also Educational Foundation, Eye Foundation, and anything your Commandery (or any member) is doing in related fields.
- E. Preparing the Material
1. Two basic forms - depending upon circumstances and media arrangements in each locality:
 - a. Outline form (listing of basic facts).
 - b. Written news release form.
 2. Suggested preparation guidelines:
 - a. Use 8 1/2 by 11 sheets of white paper, one side only.
 - 1) Avoid odd bits, shapes, and sizes of paper --- and the backs of old calendar sheets!
 - 2) Type your name, address, and phone number at the top, the release date, and the identification of your Commandery; also date submitted.
 - 3) Double-space your typing.
 - 4) Allow wide margins - and do not type to the extreme edge, top or bottom.
 - a) Paper isn't so expensive that you must use every iota of space.
 - b) If your writing covers more than one or two pages, it is possible that your article is too long - not that the paper is too short.
 - b. Be brief and factual.
 - 1) Give essential information and adequate coverage - but don't pad.
 - 2) Try to start your article with an important part of the event rather than: "A meeting was held June 1 at ... "
 - c. Names and titles are important.
 - 1) Use the middle initial when it applies.
 - 2) A married (or widowed) woman is MRS. JOHN J. DOE, not MRS. MARY M. DOE.
 - a) Subsequent use in the same article - MRS. DOE.
 - 3) The first use of the man's name is JOHN J. DOE; the subsequent use, is MR. DOE. ...
 - a) If John happens to be a Protestant minister, he is THE REVEREND JOHN J. DOE.
 - 4) The title of your Eminent Commander in a news article is COMMANDER; the title of the Most Eminent Grand Master, in public press use, is GRAND MASTER.
 - 5) Check and double-check each name for accuracy.
 - 6) Identify by title, name, and hometown.
 - d. Copy suggestions:
 - 1) Avoid becoming unduly academic.

Fancy words are not needed if good five-cent words can tell the story.

- 2) Don't write more than there is to tell - or, again, be concise.

A common misconception is using length as a measure of value or prestige. (Always remember the conciseness and impact of Lincoln's Gettysburg Address.)

- 3) After you have completed the article go over it and cross out all adjectives and all unnecessary words like "the," "a," "an," and "that." (Amazing how much better it will "" read.")
- 4) A final thought in news selection and use: Your purpose is to report news of people and events. Do not use releases simply to flatter individuals or court favor or "make them feel good." If such an article does reach print, you have used valuable time and space for an ulterior motive and have "defrauded" your readers. Give credit where credit is due, where circumstances warrant. List those who should be listed, not just because they are Templar friends and associates, but because they are involved. And, please - avoid: "lovely" ladies, "sumptuous" banquets, "jammed-to-the-rafters" entertainment events, and "inspiring" talks. Even if any of the terms would be quite accurate, your integrity should call for you to use opposite terms when the reverse is true, such as: "unattractive" ladies, "unappetizing" banquet, "deserted" entertainment hall, "dull" talks.

Examples of Copy. (See Following Pages)

1. Outline form.
2. One (no-no!) of written coverage.
3. Second (recommended) version of written coverage.

(Example I)

OUTLINE FORM

(Current Date)

(Your name, address, phone number)

(Name and number of Commandery)

(Release: Immediate or dated)

WHO: Gethsemane Commandery No. 75, Knights Templar

WHAT: Stated Conclave, conducted by John J. Doe, Commander

WHEN: Monday, December 3, 7:30 p.m.

WHERE: MASONIC TEMPLE, 331 Locust Street, Libertyville

WHY: Program of evening will be talk by Dr. James J. Jones, President, Sugar Loaf State Teachers College, a Knight Templar, on subject of proposed new free public library for Libertyville. Group discussion.

(the end)

(Example 2)

(WARNING: MAY BE INJURIOUS TO YOUR MEDIA RELATIONSHIPS - IF USED!)

A special meeting of exceptional interest was held last night in the newly painted social hall of the Masonic Temple by the local Commandery of Knights Templar with more than 200 members in evidence for a dramatic talk and a highly spirited discussion on the proposed new library for Libertyville, which was followed by delicious refreshments expertly prepared and efficiently served by the loyal members of the Ladies Auxiliary, whose President is Mrs. Mary Doe. Her husband is the Eminent Commander of Gethsemane Commandery.

Before partaking of the fine refreshments at the culmination of the assembly, the ladies enjoyed the brilliant piano music of Mrs. Jane Roe at the Steinway, recently purchased by Gethsemane Commandery's outstanding Drill Team.

The members, during this period of entertainment for the ladies, were giving their rapt attention to their speaker of the evening, who was introduced by Eminent Commander John Doe. He was Dr. James J. Jones of Sugar Loaf State Teachers College - who, incidentally, is an active member of the valiant and magnanimous Order of Knights Templar, who gave a dynamic talk about the new library proposed for Libertyville. After the talk and a fine discussion, the members joined the ladies for the piece d'occasion, the refreshments, in the social hall.

(the end)

(Please note that the form used above definitely is NOT recommended. Compare it with Example 3 on page 18 to see why.)

(Example 3)

RECOMMENDED FORM

(Same standard heading)

Dr. James J. Jones, President of Sugar Loaf State Teachers College, expressed support of Libertyville's proposed free public library in an address to 200 Knights Templar Monday evening at the Masonic Temple, 331 Locust Street.

"Every citizen owes it to the community to study every detail of the proposal," said Dr. Jones to his fellow members of Gethsemane Commandery No. 75, Knights Templar. He claimed that "apathy is the biggest enemy of the proposal," and that "too many residents think of the library as a toy, a gadget, something we really don't need."

"Such people are uninformed," said Dr. Jones. "If we have any respect for learning and for the cultural growth of our community, if we value books more than pocketbooks, we will see to it that Libertyville gets its free public library."

John J. Doe, Commander, introduced the speaker and conducted a brief question and answer period after the address by Dr. Jones.

The concurrent meeting of the Ladies Auxiliary in the social hall of the Masonic Temple featured piano music by Mrs. Richard R. Roe. Mrs. John J. Doe, President, presided for the meeting.

(the end)

KNIGHT TEMPLAR MAGAZINE

The official publication of the Grand Encampment is the monthly Knight Templar Magazine. It goes to every Templar under the jurisdiction of the Grand 30 Encampment and contains news gathered from all over the Templar world. The Knight Templar Magazine carries the messages from the Grand Master and other items of special importance to every part of our great organization. It also contains pictures and news items of Templar events in different parts of the country. It can be safely said that no officer or interested Templar can keep abreast of events unless he reads the Knight Templar Magazine. Each Grand Commandery has an official Editor whose duty it is to supply two pages of material for the Knight Templar Magazine Supplement for his state.

There is nothing like an attractive official "house organ" such as the Knight Templar Magazine to stimulate interest in Templar activities by regular monthly issues of news and interesting articles. The Templar publication is especially newsworthy because each Grand Commandery has the unusual opportunity of utilizing two pages for its own news and events, with the remaining 30 devoted to national materials. The magazine is official in that its directives carry the authority of Grand Encampment law.

GRAND ENCAMPMENT SERVICES

The office of the Grand Recorder has made available film and slide programs on historical and Templar subjects, suitable for showing to Masons, women's and youth groups as well as non-Masonic audiences. In addition, a variety of published material has been provided for Commandery use.

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Program Films (16 mm, color/sound)

Soldiers of the Cross (15 minutes)

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The Battle of Yorktown (14 minutes)

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Benjamin Franklin (15 minutes)

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Suggested Musical Listings

for the Three Orders; of the Commandery

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1967 Constitution and Statutes with Addenda (\$1.50)

Manual of Public Ceremonies (\$.50)

New and Revised Charting the Course (\$.25)

Digest of Approved Decisions (\$ 5.00) (useful for Committees on Jurisprudence)

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Revised "Charting the Course"

"Charting the Course" represents changes, revision, and updating of the booklet issued during the term of the late Sir Knight Wilber M. Brucker, Past Grand Master, and former Secretary of the Army, who served the Grand Encampment 1964-67.

This later edition still carries Sir Knight Brucker's full-hearted commitment as endorsed by his 1964 Grand Officers.

(Signed by:)

"With the help of Almighty God, we will succeed!"
Courteously and fraternally,

John L. Crofts, Sr. (then Deputy Grand Master)
G. Wilbur Bell (then Grand Generalissimo)
Roy Wilford Riegle (then Grand Captain General)

Additional copies available at 25 cents each from the office of the Grand Recorder, 14 East Jackson Boulevard, Suite 1700, Chicago, Illinois 60604.